

# *The Great Gatsby*

F. Scott Fitzgerald · 1925

Standard Ebooks edition of the 1925 Scribner text

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

**Indiana 2023 edition** (standards shown for this framework only)

9 chapter lessons plus 1 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 13 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 3 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC
*Cover: Pierre-Auguste Renoir, Luncheon of the Boating Party (1880–1881). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).*

# Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–9), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

**Edition:** The Great Gatsby was published by Charles Scribner's Sons on 10 April 1925 and entered the U.S. public domain on 1 January 2021. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition (nine chapters); some spellings follow British usage. Cite chapter and paragraph from this edition.

**Content note for teachers:** Heavy drinking, adultery, domestic violence, a fatal car crash, a murder and a suicide; Tom's racist talk and the stereotyped portrait of Wolfshiem reflect 1920s prejudices and need open, critical discussion. See the chapter notes and the safe-messaging script.

**Grades:** Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these novels are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 3. **Class days:** 13 × 90 minutes (9 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

## Essential questions

- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about the American Dream?
- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about class and money?
- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about the past and time?
- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about illusion and reality?
- What does The Great Gatsby suggest about carelessness and morality?

## Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the novel.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

## Standards: Indiana 2023

7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1

Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE

**Assessments:** Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five

**Differentiation:** Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.

**Materials:** Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

## The 90-minute lesson

| # | Segment | Mode | Minutes | Clock |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bell-ringer | You do | 8 | 0–8 |
| 2 | Vocabulary with etymology notes | I do | 10 | 8–18 |
| 3 | Background and context | I do | 10 | 18–28 |
| 4 | I do: modeled close reading | I do | 12 | 28–40 |
| 5 | We do: guided annotation | We do | 15 | 40–55 |
| 6 | You do: independent annotation | You do | 15 | 55–70 |
| 7 | Discussion | We do | 10 | 70–80 |
| 8 | Exit ticket / chapter quiz | You do | 7 | 80–87 |
| 9 | Closure | I do | 3 | 87–90 |
| | **Total** | | **90** | |

# Syllabus

| Week | Chapters | Lessons | Focus and activities | Assessment |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | *Introduction: author, context and reception*<br>Chapter I<br>Chapter II<br>Chapter III<br>Chapter IV | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *the American Dream*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Introduction: author, context and reception<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 2 | Chapter V<br>*Socratic seminar on the American Dream*<br>Chapter VI<br>Chapter VII<br>Chapter VIII | 5 × 90 min (450 min) | *class and money*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Socratic seminar on the American Dream<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt |
| 3 | Chapter IX<br>*Whole-book test (90 minutes)*<br>*Final essay workshop and submission* | 3 × 90 min (270 min) | *the past and time*<br>• Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure<br>• Chapter quizzes in the app<br>• Whole-book test (90 minutes)<br>• Final essay workshop and submission<br>• Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week) | Whole-book test and final essay |

# Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

# Lesson 1: Introduction to The Great Gatsby

### *Author biography*

Francis Scott Key Fitzgerald was born in St. Paul, Minnesota, on 24 September 1896, named for a distant relative who wrote "The Star-Spangled Banner." He attended Princeton University but left without a degree and joined the U.S. Army in 1917; the war ended before he was sent overseas. While stationed near Montgomery, Alabama, he met Zelda Sayre, who married him in 1920, a week after his first novel, This Side of Paradise, made him famous. The Fitzgeralds became celebrities of what he named "the Jazz Age," living in New York, on Long Island (Great Neck, 1922–24) and in France, where he wrote most of The Great Gatsby. His later years were marked by debt, alcoholism and Zelda's psychiatric illness; he published Tender Is the Night (1934), wrote for Hollywood, and died of a heart attack in Hollywood on 21 December 1940, aged 44, leaving The Last Tycoon unfinished. He believed himself a failure; Gatsby's reputation grew only after his death.

### *Historical and cultural context*

The novel is set in the summer of 1922 on Long Island and in New York City. Fitzgerald wrote most of it in France in 1924, after living in Great Neck, Long Island, which became his West Egg. The 1920s brought Prohibition (the Eighteenth Amendment, in force from 1920), which made bootlegging and organized crime enormously profitable; a booming stock market and new fortunes; mass-produced cars; jazz; and new freedoms for young women (the "flapper"). Meyer Wolfshiem's fixing of the 1919 World Series alludes to the real Black Sox scandal, usually linked to the gambler Arnold Rothstein. Tom Buchanan's talk of a book about "the Coloured Empires" echoes real racist best-sellers of the period, such as Lothrop Stoddard's The Rising Tide of Color (1920).

### *Publication and reception, then and now*

Charles Scribner's Sons published The Great Gatsby on 10 April 1925, edited by Maxwell Perkins, with Francis Cugat's painting of a woman's face above a carnival-lit city on the jacket. Fitzgerald had considered other titles, including "Trimalchio in West Egg." The book entered the United States public domain on 1 January 2021.

**Then:** Sales disappointed Fitzgerald: the book sold far fewer copies than his first two novels, and some reviews were dismissive. Writers admired it; T. S. Eliot wrote to Fitzgerald that it seemed "the first step that American fiction has taken since Henry James." When Fitzgerald died in 1940 he thought himself forgotten.

**Now:** Interest revived after his death; during the Second World War the book was printed in the Armed Services Editions sent to American troops. It is now one of the most taught American novels and a standard candidate for "the Great American Novel." Film versions include those of 1949, 1974 (with Robert Redford) and 2013 (Baz Luhrmann). Modern readers debate Nick's reliability, the novel's treatment of class and race, and what it says about the American Dream.

### *Overview (spoiler-free)*

In the summer of 1922 Nick Carraway, a young Midwesterner, rents a small house on Long Island next to the mansion of the mysterious Jay Gatsby, who throws enormous parties. Across the bay live Nick's cousin Daisy

and her rich husband Tom. Nick tells us what he learned that summer about Gatsby and the people around him.

### *Main themes*

- the American Dream: Gatsby remakes himself from nothing; ask whether the dream is noble, corrupt or impossible.
- class and money: old money, new money and the people who pay for both.
- the past and time: "Can't repeat the past? Why of course you can!"
- illusion and reality: Gatsby's invented self, Daisy as a dream, Nick's own self-image as honest.
- carelessness and morality: who cleans up after the careless rich?

### *Why it matters*

The Great Gatsby gives American culture a vocabulary for ambition, reinvention and excess, and asks whether wealth can buy belonging or happiness. Students practice reading a narrator critically, tracing symbols that change meaning, and connecting a 1925 novel to questions about class, race, gender and the American Dream today.

Spoilers · teacher only

Gatsby, born James Gatz, loved Daisy before the war and has made a fortune, partly through bootlegging, to win her back. Nick arranges their reunion; the affair revives. In a hot confrontation at the Plaza Hotel, Tom exposes Gatsby's criminal dealings and Daisy cannot say she never loved Tom. Driving Gatsby's car home, Daisy hits and kills Tom's mistress, Myrtle Wilson; Gatsby takes the blame. Tom tells Myrtle's grieving husband George that the car was Gatsby's; Wilson shoots Gatsby and then himself. Tom and Daisy leave town; almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral. Nick returns to the Midwest.

### *Lesson plan (90 minutes)*

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
>
> *Before we open The Great Gatsby: What does "the American Dream" mean to you? Is it still possible? Write for five minutes.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open The Great Gatsby: What does "the American Dream" mean to you? Is it still possible? Write for five minutes.

> **8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)**
>
> *narrator (the person telling the story; here a character, Nick); unreliable narrator (one whose account we may not fully trust); symbol (an object that stands for an idea); Prohibition (the 1920–1933 national ban on making and selling alcohol); bootlegger (someone who sold alcohol illegally); old money and new money (inherited wealth versus newly made fortunes); the Jazz Age (Fitzgerald's name for the 1920s).*

**18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)**

*About the author. Francis Scott Key Fitzgerald was born in St. Paul, Minnesota, on 24 September 1896, named for a distant relative who wrote "The Star-Spangled Banner." He attended Princeton University but left without a degree and joined the U.S. Army in 1917; the war ended before he was sent overseas. While stationed near Montgomery, Alabama, he met Zelda Sayre, who married him in 1920, a week after his first novel, This Side of Paradise, made him famous. The Fitzgeralds became celebrities of what he named "the Jazz Age," living in New York, on Long Island (Great Neck, 1922–24) and in France, where he wrote most of The Great Gatsby. His later years were marked by debt, alcoholism and Zelda's psychiatric illness; he published Tender Is the Night (1934), wrote for Hollywood, and died of a heart attack in Hollywood on 21 December 1940, aged 44, leaving The Last Tycoon unfinished. He believed himself a failure; Gatsby's reputation grew only after his death. The world of the book. The novel is set in the summer of 1922 on Long Island and in New York City. Fitzgerald wrote most of it in France in 1924, after living in Great Neck, Long Island, which became his West Egg. The 1920s brought Prohibition (the Eighteenth Amendment, in force from 1920), which made bootlegging and organized crime enormously profitable; a booming stock market and new fortunes; mass-produced cars; jazz; and new freedoms for young women (the "flapper"). Meyer Wolfshiem's fixing of the 1919 World Series alludes to the real Black Sox scandal, usually linked to the gambler Arnold Rothstein. Tom Buchanan's talk of a book about "the Coloured Empires" echoes real racist best-sellers of the period, such as Lothrop Stoddard's The Rising Tide of Color (1920). Publication and reception. Charles Scribner's Sons published The Great Gatsby on 10 April 1925, edited by Maxwell Perkins, with Francis Cugat's painting of a woman's face above a carnival-lit city on the jacket. Fitzgerald had considered other titles, including "Trimalchio in West Egg." The book entered the United States public domain on 1 January 2021. Then: Sales disappointed Fitzgerald: the book sold far fewer copies than his first two novels, and some reviews were dismissive. Writers admired it; T. S. Eliot wrote to Fitzgerald that it seemed "the first step that American fiction has taken since Henry James." When Fitzgerald died in 1940 he thought himself forgotten. Now: Interest revived after his death; during the Second World War the book was printed in the Armed Services Editions sent to American troops. It is now one of the most taught American novels and a standard candidate for "the Great American Novel." Film versions include those of 1949, 1974 (with Robert Redford) and 2013 (Baz Luhrmann). Modern readers debate Nick's reliability, the novel's treatment of class and race, and what it says about the American Dream.*

**28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)**

*“So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162). The novel's last sentence. Read it on day one without context; ask students what it might mean, then revisit it at the end.*

> *So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past (Chapter IX, paragraph 162)*

**Think-aloud:** “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162). The novel's last sentence. Read it on day one without context; ask students what it might mean, then revisit it at the end.

**40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)**

*What the book is about (no spoilers): In the summer of 1922 Nick Carraway, a young Midwesterner, rents a small house on Long Island next to the mansion of the mysterious Jay Gatsby, who throws enormous parties. Across the bay live Nick's cousin Daisy and her rich husband Tom. Nick tells us what he learned that summer about Gatsby and the people around him. Themes to track: the American Dream: Gatsby remakes himself from nothing; ask whether the dream is noble, corrupt or impossible. class and money: old money, new money and the people who pay for both. the past and time: "Can't repeat the past? Why of course you can!" illusion and reality: Gatsby's invented self, Daisy as a dream, Nick's own self-image as honest. carelessness and morality: who cleans up after the careless rich?*

**55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)**

*Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "illusion and reality": Prediction: Gatsby is not who he says he is. Question: does Nick tell us everything, or only what he wants us to see?*
**Task:** Set up a reading journal for The Great Gatsby: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
**Exemplar:** Theme page "illusion and reality": Prediction: Gatsby is not who he says he is. Question: does Nick tell us everything, or only what he wants us to see?

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

*Why does The Great Gatsby still matter? The Great Gatsby gives American culture a vocabulary for ambition, reinvention and excess, and asks whether wealth can buy belonging or happiness. Students practice reading a narrator critically, tracing symbols that change meaning, and connecting a 1925 novel to questions about class, race, gender and the American Dream today.*
**Anchor question:** Why might The Great Gatsby still be taught today?
**Facilitation:** The Great Gatsby gives American culture a vocabulary for ambition, reinvention and excess, and asks whether wealth can buy belonging or happiness. Students practice reading a narrator critically, tracing symbols that change meaning, and connecting a 1925 novel to questions about class, race, gender and the American Dream today.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)**

*Name one fact about the 1920s that will help you understand the novel. Answer: Examples: Prohibition made bootlegging profitable (Gatsby's money); the 1919 World Series fix (Wolfshiem); new fortunes and the stock boom (West Egg versus East Egg); cars and new freedoms for women (Jordan, Daisy).*
**Exit ticket:** Name one fact about the 1920s that will help you understand the novel.
**Answer:** Examples: Prohibition made bootlegging profitable (Gatsby's money); the 1919 World Series fix (Wolfshiem); new fortunes and the stock boom (West Egg versus East Egg); cars and new freedoms for women (Jordan, Daisy).

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**

*Tomorrow we begin reading: Chapter I.*

**Teacher notes · sources:** Britannica, "F. Scott Fitzgerald" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/F-Scott-Fitzgerald); University of South Carolina Libraries, F. Scott Fitzgerald Collection, "Fitzgerald biography" (https://sc.edu/about/offices_and_divisions/university_libraries/browse/irvin_dept_special_collections/fitzgerald/); Britannica, "The Great Gatsby" (https://www.britannica.com/topic/The-Great-Gatsby); Library of Congress, "Prohibition: A Case Study of Progressive Reform" (https://www.loc.gov/classroom-materials/united-states-history-primary-source-timeline/progressive-era-to-new-era-1900-1929/prohibition-case-study-of-progressive-reform/); Princeton University Library, F. Scott Fitzgerald Papers (https://findingaids.princeton.edu/catalog/C0187); Duke University Center for the Study of the Public Domain, "Public Domain Day 2021" (https://web.law.duke.edu/cspd/publicdomainday/2021/); T. S. Eliot, letter to Fitzgerald, 31 December 1925 (printed in Fitzgerald, The Crack-Up, 1945) (https://www.worldcat.org/)

**Flags (verify before teaching):**

- Sales figures for 1925 vary by source (a first printing of about 20,000 and a smaller second printing are usually cited); avoid exact numbers unless you check them.
- The Rothstein link to Wolfshiem is a common identification, not something Fitzgerald stated in the novel.
- The Armed Services Editions printing (1945) is well documented; the often-quoted figure of about 150,000 copies should be checked before use.

# Lesson 2: Chapter I

**Focus:** Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

**Content note (racist ideas (a character)):** Tom praises a racist book about 'the Coloured Empires' and the dominance of 'the Nordic race.' Fitzgerald presents it as Tom's ignorance; name the real 1920s pseudo-science it echoes and why the novel mocks it.
**Student preview:** A character repeats racist ideas from a 1920s book; the novel treats them as foolish.
**Suggested language:** "What does Tom's speech show about him, and how do the others react?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Nick Carraway, a Yale graduate from a well-off Midwestern family, explains that he came East in 1922 to learn the bond business and rented a small house in West Egg beside Gatsby's mansion. He dines across the bay in East Egg with his cousin Daisy, her husband Tom Buchanan (a former Yale football star with a 'cruel body') and the golfer Jordan Baker. Tom rants about a racist book; a phone call reveals that Tom has a mistress; Daisy tells Nick she hopes her daughter will be 'a beautiful little fool.' Back home, Nick sees Gatsby alone on his lawn, stretching his arms toward a green light across the water.

**Background:** Great Neck and Manhasset Neck on Long Island's North Shore were home to new show-business fortunes and old society families in the early 1920s; Fitzgerald lived in Great Neck in 1922–24. After the First World War many young men from the Midwest moved east to work in finance, as Nick does.

**Significance:** The opening establishes Nick as both guide and suspect witness, maps the novel's class geography (West Egg versus East Egg), and plants its key symbol, the green light.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to class and money because.... Content note before we start: A character repeats racist ideas from a 1920s book; the novel treats them as foolish.*
**Prompt:** Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to class and money because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: eyesore — something ugly that spoils a view; bungalow — a one-story house, originally in India, with a wide veranda; participated — shared with others; bizarre — conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual; tolerance — willingness to accept others' beliefs or ways.*
**Words:** eyesore: something ugly that spoils a view · bungalow: a one-story house, originally in India, with a wide veranda · participated: shared with others · bizarre: conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual · tolerance: willingness to accept others' beliefs or ways

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Great Neck and Manhasset Neck on Long Island's North Shore were home to new show-business fortunes and old society families in the early 1920s; Fitzgerald lived in Great Neck in 1922–24. After the First World War many young men from the Midwest moved east to work in finance, as Nick does. The opening establishes Nick as both guide and suspect witness, maps the novel's class geography (West Egg versus East Egg), and plants its key symbol, the green light. Point of view: Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims. Setting: West Egg (new money, Nick's "eyesore" and Gatsby's mansion) faces East Egg (old money, the Buchanans) across the bay. Characterization: Tom's "cruel body," Daisy's thrilling voice and despairing irony, Jordan's balanced boredom. Watch for the green light: Gatsby, alone at night, stretches his arms toward "a single green light, minute and far away."*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1). The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. That is point of view at work: Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims.*

> *In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since (Chapter I, paragraph 1)*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1). The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. That is point of view at work: Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Daisy says a girl is best off a "beautiful little fool" because a smart woman sees how little power she has. Expected link: class and money; gender in the 1920s. Ask: How does this line connect to class and money? Expected: The geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. (Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options.)*

> *I hope she'll be a fool—that's the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool (Chapter I, paragraph 118)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Daisy says a girl is best off a "beautiful little fool" because a smart woman sees how little power she has. Expected link: class and money; gender in the 1920s.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to class and money?
**Expected answer:** The geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. (Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for point of view, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. When the text says "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152), it shows this directly. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for point of view, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. When the text says "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152), it shows this directly. He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not? Ask: what kind of person is Nick? List what he says about himself and what he shows.*
**Anchor question:** Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not?
**Facilitation:** Ask: what kind of person is Nick? List what he says about himself and what he shows.

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. ("a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock", Chapter I, paragraph 152). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. ("a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock", Chapter I, paragraph 152). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how point of view shapes Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Key takeaway: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Point of view:** Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims.
- **Setting:** West Egg (new money, Nick's "eyesore" and Gatsby's mansion) faces East Egg (old money, the Buchanans) across the bay.
- **Characterization:** Tom's "cruel body," Daisy's thrilling voice and despairing irony, Jordan's balanced boredom.

### Themes and how they develop

- **class and money:** the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the green light:** Gatsby, alone at night, stretches his arms toward "a single green light, minute and far away."

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1) The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair.
- "I hope she'll be a fool—that's the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool" (Chapter I, paragraph 118) Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options.
- "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152) First image of the green light.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested.
**Evidence:** "a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock" (Chapter I, paragraph 152)
**Reasoning:** He opens with his father's advice he has been "turning over in my mind ever since" and claims to reserve judgment, yet his portraits of Tom and Daisy are sharply judgmental, and he alone sees Gatsby reach toward "a single green light, minute and far away."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **eyesore** (noun) | something ugly that spoils a view | *My own house was an eyesore, but it was a small eyesore, and it had been overlooked, so I had a view of the water, a partial view of my neighbour's lawn, and the consoling proximity of millionaires—all for eighty dollars a month.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bungalow** (noun) | a one-story house, originally in India, with a wide veranda | *He found the house, a weather-beaten cardboard bungalow at eighty a month, but at the last minute the firm ordered him to Washington, and I went out to the country alone.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **participated** (verb) | shared with others | *I graduated from New Haven in 1915, just a quarter of a century after my father, and a little later I participated in that delayed Teutonic migration known as the Great War.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bizarre** (adjective) | conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual | *I lived at West Egg, the—well, the less fashionable of the two, though this is a most superficial tag to express the bizarre and not a little sinister contrast between them.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **tolerance** (noun) | willingness to accept others' beliefs or ways | *And, after boasting this way of my tolerance, I come to the admission that it has a limit.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **submerged** (verb) | sink below the surface; go under or as if under water | *The idea is if we don't look out the white race will be—will be utterly submerged.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **supercilious** (adjective) | behaving as if superior to others | *Now he was a sturdy straw-haired man of thirty, with a rather hard mouth and a supercilious manner.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **egotism** (noun) | too much concern with oneself | *Something was making him nibble at the edge of stale ideas as if his sturdy physical egotism no longer nourished his peremptory heart.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **politely** (adverb) | in a polite manner | *He turned me around again, politely and abruptly.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **shifting** (verb) | changing | *"You ought to live in California—" began Miss Baker, but Tom interrupted her by shifting heavily in his chair.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the American Dream?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What sport did Tom play at Yale? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Football; he was a famous end.
2. What does Jordan Baker do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She is a golf champion.
3. Where does Nick rent a house? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: West Egg
4. What business has Nick come East to learn? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Bonds
5. How is Nick related to Daisy? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Second cousin once removed

6. What does Daisy hope her daughter will be? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A beautiful little fool
7. What does Gatsby reach toward at the end of the chapter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A green light
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Nick Carraway, a Yale graduate from a well-off Midwestern family, explains that he came East in 1922 to learn the bond business and rented a small house in West Egg beside Gatsby's mansion. He dines across the bay in East Egg with his cousin Daisy, her husband Tom Buchanan (a former Yale football star with a 'cruel body') and the golfer Jordan Baker. Tom rants about a racist book; a phone call…
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter I"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the narrator begin with his father's advice? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To present himself as fair and reserved, which the reader can then test.
2. What do the descriptions of East and West Egg suggest about class? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: East Egg is older, more fashionable money; West Egg is new and showy.
3. What does "Chapter I" suggest about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The opening establishes Nick as both guide and suspect witness, maps the novel's class geography (West Egg versus East Egg), and plants its key symbol, the green light.
4. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
5. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: "In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I've been turning over in my mind ever since" (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. On setting: West Egg (new money, Nick's "eyesore" and Gatsby's mansion) faces East Egg (old money, the Buchanans) across the bay. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins "The practical thing was to find rooms in the city, but it was a warm season, and I had just left a country of wide lawns and friendly trees, so when a young man at the office…", why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Nick Carraway, a Yale graduate from a well-off Midwestern family, explains that he came East in 1922 to learn the bond business and rented a small house in West Egg beside Gatsby's mansion. He dines across the bay in East Egg with his cousin Daisy, her husband Tom Buchanan (a former Yale football…
8. As the opening chapter, what does “Chapter I” set up that the rest of The Great Gatsby will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118): Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152): First image of the green light. On characterization: Tom's "cruel body," Daisy's thrilling voice and despairing irony, Jordan's balanced boredom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Do you trust people who say they never judge others? Why or why not?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Nick reliable after Chapter I? Defend your answer with two details. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment based on his claims and his sharp judgments of others.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. What does Daisy's 'beautiful little fool' line say about women's choices in 1922? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned connection to gender and power.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118): Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. A critic might argue: “The opening establishes Nick as both guide and suspect witness, maps the novel's class geography (West Egg versus East Egg), and plants its key symbol, the green light.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152): First image of the green light. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. On characterization: Tom's "cruel body," Daisy's thrilling voice and despairing irony, Jordan's balanced boredom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter I” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118): Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. On point of view: Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152): First image of the green light. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to class and money: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs

maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “I hope she’ll be a fool—that’s the best thing a girl can be in this world, a beautiful little fool” (Chapter I, paragraph 118): Daisy on her daughter: a bitter view of women's options. On point of view: Nick introduces himself as a narrator "inclined to reserve all judgements," then judges everyone; the reader must weigh his claims. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter I” treats Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “a single green light, minute and far away, that might have been the end of a dock” (Chapter I, paragraph 152): First image of the green light. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter II” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets up Nick as a narrator whose claims of fairness must be tested. Useful evidence: “In my younger and more vulnerable years my father gave me some advice that I’ve been turning over in my mind ever since” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): The opening sentence: Nick presents himself as thoughtful and fair. Theme link: the geography of the Eggs maps the divide between new and inherited wealth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Where does Nick rent a house?

   A. East Egg

   B. Chicago

   C. Manhattan

   D. West Egg

2. What business has Nick come East to learn?
   A. Medicine
   B. Law
   C. Bonds
   D. Journalism
3. How is Nick related to Daisy?
   A. Second cousin once removed
   B. Neighbour only
   C. Husband
   D. Brother
4. What does Daisy hope her daughter will be?
   A. A beautiful little fool
   B. Famous
   C. A doctor
   D. Rich
5. What does Gatsby reach toward at the end of the chapter?
   A. His mansion
   B. A green light
   C. The moon
   D. A boat
6. In the line "My own house was an eyesore, but it was a small eyesore, and it had been overlooked, so I had a view of the water, a partial view of my neighbour's lawn, and the consoling proximity of millionaires—all for eighty dollars a month.", what does "eyesore" most nearly mean?
   A. a one-story house, originally in India, with a wide veranda
   B. shared with others
   C. conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual
   D. something ugly that spoils a view
7. In the line "He found the house, a weather-beaten cardboard bungalow at eighty a month, but at the last minute the firm ordered him to Washington, and I went out to the country alone.", what does "bungalow" most nearly mean?
   A. shared with others
   B. a one-story house, originally in India, with a wide veranda
   C. conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual
   D. something ugly that spoils a view

**Answer key:** 1. D (West Egg); 2. C (Bonds); 3. A (Second cousin once removed); 4. A (A beautiful little fool); 5. B (A green light); 6. D (something ugly that spoils a view); 7. B (a one-story house, originally in India, with a wide veranda)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter I,” how does Fitzgerald show Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter I, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter I suggests about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses point of view in Chapter I to complicate the reader's understanding of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter I and its treatment of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter I as evidence for a larger claim about Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *I graduated from New Haven in 1915, just a quarter of a century after my father, and a little later I participated in that delayed Teutonic migration known as the Great War.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “participated” most nearly mean?

   A. changing

   B. too much concern with oneself

   C. in a polite manner

   D. shared with others

2. *The practical thing was to find rooms in the city, but it was a warm season, and I had just left a country of wide lawns and friendly trees, so when a young man at the office suggested that we take a house together in a commuting town, it sounded like a great idea. He found the house, a weather-beaten cardboard bungalow at eighty a month, but at the last minute the firm ordered him to Washington, and I went out to the country alone. I had a dog—at least I had him for a few days until he ran away—and an old Dodge and a Finnish woman, who made my bed and cooked breakfast and muttered Finnish wisdom to herself over the electric stove.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter I”?

   A. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

   B. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

   C. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

   D. The Plaza and the death car

**SAT key:** 1. D (shared with others); 2. C (Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans)

## Lesson 3: Chapter II

**Focus:** the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

**Content note (domestic violence, heavy drinking):** Tom breaks Myrtle's nose. Some students may have experienced violence at home; keep focus on what the act reveals about power and class.
**Student preview:** A man hits a woman in this chapter.
**Suggested language:** "What does this moment reveal about Tom?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Between West Egg and New York lies a valley of ashes, overseen by the faded billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Tom takes Nick to George Wilson's garage there and brings Wilson's wife, Myrtle, into the city to the apartment he keeps for her. At a drunken party with Myrtle's sister Catherine and the McKees, Myrtle buys a dog and puts on airs. When she shouts Daisy's name, Tom breaks her nose with his open hand.

**Background:** The ash dump was modeled on the Corona ash dumps in Queens, where coal ash and garbage were dumped; it was later transformed into Flushing Meadows for the 1939 World's Fair. Billboards along new roads were a sign of the car age.

**Significance:** The chapter shows who pays for the glamour: the Wilsons live in the grey waste the rich drive through, and Tom's violence exposes the brutality under his class.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What does a place reveal about the people who live there? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to class and money because.... Content note before we start: A man hits a woman in this chapter.*
**Prompt:** What does a place reveal about the people who live there?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to class and money because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: cowered — crouch or curl up; hauteur — overbearing pride evidenced by a superior manner toward inferiors; screens — decorated panels used to shield from heat or drafts; bracelets — bands or chains worn around the wrist; inexhaustible — that cannot be entirely consumed or used up.*
**Words:** cowered: crouch or curl up · hauteur: overbearing pride evidenced by a superior manner toward inferiors · screens: decorated panels used to shield from heat or drafts · bracelets: bands or chains worn around the wrist · inexhaustible: that cannot be entirely consumed or used up

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*The ash dump was modeled on the Corona ash dumps in Queens, where coal ash and garbage were dumped; it was later transformed into Flushing Meadows for the 1939 World's Fair. Billboards along new roads were a sign of the car age. The chapter shows who pays for the glamour: the Wilsons live in the grey waste the rich drive through, and Tom's violence exposes the brutality under his class. Setting: The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Symbolism: Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing. Characterization: Tom's violence: he breaks Myrtle's nose with his open hand. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "saw us a damp gleam of hope sprang into his light blue eyes" (Chapter II, paragraph 8).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1). The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. That is setting at work: The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg.*

> *This is a valley of ashes (Chapter II, paragraph 1)*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1). The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. That is setting at work: The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The billboard eyes. Look at the craft: Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing. Ask: How does this line connect to class and money? Expected: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. (The billboard eyes.)*

> *The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic (Chapter II, paragraph 2)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** The billboard eyes. Look at the craft: Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to class and money?
**Expected answer:** Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. (The billboard eyes.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. When the text says “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. When the text says “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: What does a place reveal about the people who live there? Ask: why does Fitzgerald put the valley of ashes between the Eggs and the city?*

**Anchor question:** What does a place reveal about the people who live there?

**Facilitation:** Ask: why does Fitzgerald put the valley of ashes between the Eggs and the city?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. (“This is a valley of ashes”, Chapter II, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. (“This is a valley of ashes”, Chapter II, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how setting shapes the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Key takeaway: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Setting:** The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg.
- **Symbolism:** Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing.
- **Characterization:** Tom's violence: he breaks Myrtle's nose with his open hand.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **class and money:** Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “saw us a damp gleam of hope sprang into his light blue eyes” (Chapter II, paragraph 8).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “drift endlessly over it, you perceive, after a moment, the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. The eyes of Doctor T. J” (Chapter II, paragraph 2).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1) The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.
- “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2) The billboard eyes.
- “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127) Tom's casual violence.
- “I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life” (Chapter II, paragraph 119) Nick's double position.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs.
**Evidence:** “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1)

**Reasoning:** Fitzgerald calls it "a valley of ashes" watched by the eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, and Tom's casual violence there ("broke her nose with his open hand") shows how the rich treat those below them.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **cowered** (verb) | crouch or curl up | *In a basket swung from his neck cowered a dozen very recent puppies of an indeterminate breed.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **hauteur** (noun) | overbearing pride evidenced by a superior manner toward inferiors | *The intense vitality that had been so remarkable in the garage was converted into impressive hauteur.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **screens** (noun) | decorated panels used to shield from heat or drafts | *Occasionally a line of grey cars crawls along an invisible track, gives out a ghastly creak, and comes to rest, and immediately the ash-grey men swarm up with leaden spades and stir up an impenetrable cloud, which screens their obscure operations from your sight.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bracelets** (noun) | bands or chains worn around the wrist | *When she moved about there was an incessant clicking as innumerable pottery bracelets jingled up and down upon her arms.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **inexhaustible** (adjective) | that cannot be entirely consumed or used up | *I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **crouched** (verb) | bend one's back forward from the waist on down | *The interior was unprosperous and bare; the only car visible was the dust-covered wreck of a Ford which crouched in a dim corner.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **purchases** (noun) | the acquisition of something for payment | *Wilson gathered up her dog and her other purchases, and went haughtily in.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **resented** (verb) | felt angry about | *His acquaintances resented the fact that he turned up in popular cafés with her and, leaving her at a table, sauntered about, chatting with whomsoever he knew.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **vicinity** (noun) | a surrounding or nearby region | *A white ashen dust veiled his dark suit and his pale hair as it veiled everything in the vicinity—except his wife, who moved close to Tom.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **secrecy** (noun) | the trait of keeping things secret | *Yet high over the city our line of yellow windows must have contributed their share of human secrecy to the casual watcher in the darkening streets, and I saw him too, looking up and wondering.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What does a place reveal about the people who live there?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with class and money?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Who is Catherine? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Myrtle's sister.
2. What rumour does Catherine repeat about Gatsby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: That he is a nephew or cousin of Kaiser Wilhelm.
3. What lies between West Egg and New York? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A valley of ashes
4. Whose eyes look out from the billboard? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Doctor T. J. Eckleburg's
5. What does George Wilson do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Runs a garage
6. What does Myrtle buy on the way to the apartment? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A dog
7. What does Tom do when Myrtle says Daisy's name? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Breaks her nose
8. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Between West Egg and New York lies a valley of ashes, overseen by the faded billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Tom takes Nick to George Wilson's garage there and brings Wilson's wife, Myrtle, into the city to the apartment he keeps for her. At a drunken party with Myrtle's sister Catherine and the McKees, Myrtle buys a dog and puts on airs. When she shouts Daisy's name, Tom breaks her nose…
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter II”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does “Chapter II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. Why are Eckleburg's eyes described as watching the valley? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: They suggest a god-like witness, or the absence of one.

2. Why does Myrtle act grand at the apartment? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She performs the class she hopes Tom will give her.
3. What does "Chapter II" suggest about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The chapter shows who pays for the glamour: the Wilsons live in the grey waste the rich drive through, and Tom's violence exposes the brutality under his class.
4. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
5. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: "This is a valley of ashes" (Chapter II, paragraph 1): The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. On symbolism: Eckleburg's eyes "brood on over the solemn dumping ground": a god-like witness who sees nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins "About halfway between West Egg and New York the motor road hastily joins the railroad and runs beside it for a quarter of a mile, so as to shrink away from a certain desolate area…", why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in "Chapter II", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Between West Egg and New York lies a valley of ashes, overseen by the faded billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Tom takes Nick to George Wilson's garage there and brings Wilson's wife, Myrtle, into the city to the apartment he keeps for her. At a drunken party with Myrtle's sister Catherine…
8. How does "Chapter II" build on "Chapter I"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: "The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic" (Chapter II, paragraph 2): The billboard eyes. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: "Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand" (Chapter II, paragraph 127): Tom's casual violence. On characterization: Tom's violence: he breaks Myrtle's nose with his open hand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: "What does a place reveal about the people who live there?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Myrtle a victim, a social climber, or both? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned view with evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life” (Chapter II, paragraph 119): Nick's double position. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Why does Nick stay at the party although he wants to leave? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: His fascination and passivity: 'within and without'.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “The chapter shows who pays for the glamour: the Wilsons live in the grey waste the rich drive through, and Tom's violence exposes the brutality under his class.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2): The billboard eyes. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127): Tom's casual violence. On characterization: Tom's violence: he breaks Myrtle's nose with his open hand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter II” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life” (Chapter II, paragraph 119): Nick's double position. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to the past and time: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “The eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg are blue and gigantic” (Chapter II, paragraph 2): The billboard eyes. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “Making a short deft movement, Tom Buchanan broke her nose with his open hand” (Chapter II, paragraph 127): Tom's casual violence. On setting: The valley of ashes, a grey industrial wasteland between West Egg and New York, watched by the billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter II” treats the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “I was within and without, simultaneously enchanted and repelled by the inexhaustible variety of life” (Chapter II, paragraph 119): Nick's double position. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter III” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The valley of ashes shows the human cost hidden beneath the glamour of the Eggs. Useful evidence: “This is a valley of ashes” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): The wasteland that wealth leaves behind. Theme link: Myrtle tries to buy her way into Tom's world (a dog, a flat, a new dress); Wilson is drained of life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What lies between West Egg and New York?
   A. A golf course
   B. A lake
   C. A forest
   D. A valley of ashes
2. Whose eyes look out from the billboard?
   A. Gatsby's
   B. Tom's
   C. Doctor T. J. Eckleburg's
   D. Wilson's
3. What does George Wilson do?
   A. Bootlegs
   B. Runs a garage
   C. Plays golf
   D. Sells bonds
4. What does Myrtle buy on the way to the apartment?
   A. A dog
   B. A car
   C. A ring
   D. A dress only
5. What does Tom do when Myrtle says Daisy's name?
   A. Breaks her nose
   B. Leaves
   C. Laughs
   D. Apologizes
6. In the line “In a basket swung from his neck cowered a dozen very recent puppies of an indeterminate breed.”, what does “cowered” most nearly mean?
   A. crouch or curl up
   B. decorated panels used to shield from heat or drafts
   C. overbearing pride evidenced by a superior manner toward inferiors
   D. bands or chains worn around the wrist

7. In the line “The intense vitality that had been so remarkable in the garage was converted into impressive hauteur.”, what does “hauteur” most nearly mean?

   A. bands or chains worn around the wrist

   B. crouch or curl up

   C. overbearing pride evidenced by a superior manner toward inferiors

   D. decorated panels used to shield from heat or drafts

**Answer key:** 1. D (A valley of ashes); 2. C (Doctor T. J. Eckleburg's); 3. B (Runs a garage); 4. A (A dog); 5. A (Breaks her nose); 6. A (crouch or curl up); 7. C (overbearing pride evidenced by a superior manner toward inferiors)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter II,” how does Fitzgerald show the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter II, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter II suggests about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses setting in Chapter II to complicate the reader's understanding of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter II and its treatment of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter II as evidence for a larger claim about the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the valley of ashes and Myrtle's party. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Occasionally a line of grey cars crawls along an invisible track, gives out a ghastly creak, and comes to rest, and immediately the ash-grey men swarm up with leaden spades and stir up an impenetrable cloud, which screens their obscure operations from your sight.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “screens” most nearly mean?

   A. the trait of keeping things secret

   B. decorated panels used to shield from heat or drafts

   C. felt angry about

   D. a surrounding or nearby region

2. *About halfway between West Egg and New York the motor road hastily joins the railroad and runs beside it for a quarter of a mile, so as to shrink away from a certain desolate area of land. This is a valley of ashes—a fantastic farm where ashes grow like wheat into ridges and hills and grotesque gardens; where ashes take the forms of houses and chimneys and rising smoke and, finally, with a transcendent effort, of ash-grey men, who move dimly and already crumbling through the powdery air. Occasionally a line of grey cars crawls along an invisible track, gives out a ghastly creak, and comes to rest, and immediately the ash-grey men swarm up with leaden spades and stir up an impenetrable cloud, which screens their obscure operations from your sight.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter II”?

   A. The reunion

   B. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

   C. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

   D. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

**SAT key:** 1. B (decorated panels used to shield from heat or drafts); 2. D (The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party)

# Lesson 4: Chapter III

**Focus:** Gatsby's party

Teacher only · spoilers

Nick receives a formal invitation to one of Gatsby's parties, where hundreds of uninvited guests drink, dance and gossip about the host. With Jordan he meets the owl-eyed man in the library, amazed that the books are real. Nick talks with a young man who turns out to be Gatsby, with his reassuring smile and 'old sport.' Gatsby speaks privately with Jordan. Leaving, guests see a car wreck in the ditch. Nick describes his own ordinary life and his friendship with Jordan, who lies and is a careless driver.

**Background:** During Prohibition (1920–1933) alcohol flowed at private parties; jazz orchestras, cocktails and new dances were features of the age.

**Significance:** The party presents Gatsby through rumour and spectacle before revealing the man, and links carelessness (driving, honesty) to the novel's moral concerns.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to illusion and reality because....*
**Prompt:** What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to illusion and reality because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: uncontrollable — difficult to solve or alleviate; disapprove — consider bad or wrong; dangling — hang freely; mornings — the time period between dawn and noon; ghostly — resembling or characteristic of a phantom.*
**Words:** uncontrollable: difficult to solve or alleviate · disapprove: consider bad or wrong · dangling: hang freely · mornings: the time period between dawn and noon · ghostly: resembling or characteristic of a phantom

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*During Prohibition (1920–1933) alcohol flowed at private parties; jazz orchestras, cocktails and new dances were features of the age. The party presents Gatsby through rumour and spectacle before revealing the man, and links carelessness (driving, honesty) to the novel's moral concerns. Imagery: Gatsby's party in sensory overload: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars." Characterization: Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport." Irony: Guests gossip about Gatsby (he killed a man, he was a German spy) while drinking his liquor. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "of faces and voices and colour under the constantly changing light" (Chapter III, paragraph 5).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it" (Chapter III, paragraph 76). Gatsby's charm. That is imagery at work: Gatsby's party in sensory overload: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars."*

> *It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it (Chapter III, paragraph 76)*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it" (Chapter III, paragraph 76). Gatsby's charm. That is imagery at work: Gatsby's party in sensory overload: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars."

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Moths fly to light and are burned. Expected link: illusion and reality; the guests are drawn to Gatsby's glitter. Ask: How does this line connect to illusion and reality? Expected: The owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. (The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light.)*

> *In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars (Chapter III, paragraph 1)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Moths fly to light and are burned. Expected link: illusion and reality; the guests are drawn to Gatsby's glitter.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to illusion and reality?
**Expected answer:** The owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. (The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of Gatsby's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. When the text says "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars" (Chapter III, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for imagery, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of Gatsby's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. When the text says "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars" (Chapter III, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them? Ask: should we trust Nick's claim to honesty after this chapter?*

**Anchor question:** What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them?

**Facilitation:** Ask: should we trust Nick's claim to honesty after this chapter?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's party? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. ("In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars", Chapter III, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's party? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. ("In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars", Chapter III, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how imagery shapes Gatsby's party. Key takeaway: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Imagery:** Gatsby's party in sensory overload: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars."
- **Characterization:** Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport."
- **Irony:** Guests gossip about Gatsby (he killed a man, he was a German spy) while drinking his liquor.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **illusion and reality:** the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “of faces and voices and colour under the constantly changing light” (Chapter III, paragraph 5).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “She narrowed her eyes and shivered. Lucille shivered. We all turned and looked around for” (Chapter III, paragraph 36).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1) The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light.
- “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76) Gatsby's charm.
- “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171) Nick's self-assessment.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections.
**Evidence:** “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1)
**Reasoning:** Guests come "like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars," yet most never meet

their host, and Nick, who calls himself "one of the few honest people that I have ever known," invites us to judge them.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **uncontrollable** (adjective) | difficult to solve or alleviate | *We were sitting at a table with a man of about my age and a rowdy little girl, who gave way upon the slightest provocation to uncontrollable laughter.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **disapprove** (verb) | consider bad or wrong | *I liked to walk up Fifth Avenue and pick out romantic women from the crowd and imagine that in a few minutes I was going to enter into their lives, and no one would ever know or disapprove.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dangling** (verb) | hang freely | *Then, very gradually, part by part, a pale, dangling individual stepped out of the wreck, pawing tentatively at the ground with a large uncertain dancing shoe.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **mornings** (noun) | the time period between dawn and noon | *I noticed that she wore her evening-dress, all her dresses, like sports clothes—there was a jauntiness about her movements as if she had first learned to walk upon golf courses on clean, crisp mornings.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ghostly** (adjective) | resembling or characteristic of a phantom | *The crowd—it was now a crowd—stepped back involuntarily, and when the door had opened wide there was a ghostly pause.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **meetings** (noun) | a formally arranged gathering | *The bar is in full swing, and floating rounds of cocktails permeate the garden outside, until the air is alive with chatter and laughter, and casual innuendo and introductions forgotten on the spot, and enthusiastic meetings between women who never knew each other's names.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **courses** (noun) | sets of dishes served together at a meal | *I noticed that she wore her evening-dress, all her dresses, like sports clothes—there was a jauntiness about her movements as if she had first learned to walk upon golf courses on clean, crisp mornings.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **entertainment** (noun) | an activity that is diverting and that holds the attention | *At a lull in the entertainment the man looked at me and smiled.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **floating** (adjective) | drifting on water | *The bar is in full swing, and floating rounds of cocktails permeate the garden outside, until the air is alive with chatter and laughter, and casual innuendo and introductions forgotten on the spot, and enthusiastic meetings between women who never knew each other's names.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **attracted** (verb) | direct toward itself or oneself by means of some psychological power or physical attributes | *Vladimir Tostoff's latest work, which attracted so much attention at Carnegie Hall last May.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them?
2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the past and time?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Who among the guests has actually been invited? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Very few; most just come.
2. What does Jordan tell Nick about her talk with Gatsby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Something 'the most amazing'; she can't tell yet.
3. How is Nick invited? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A formal note delivered by a chauffeur
4. What surprises the owl-eyed man? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The books are real
5. What does Gatsby call people? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Old sport
6. What happens as guests leave? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A car crashes into a ditch
7. What does Nick say about Jordan's honesty? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She is incurably dishonest
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Nick receives a formal invitation to one of Gatsby's parties, where hundreds of uninvited guests drink, dance and gossip about the host. With Jordan he meets the owl-eyed man in the library, amazed that the books are real. Nick talks with a young man who turns out to be Gatsby, with his reassuring smile and 'old sport.' Gatsby speaks privately with Jordan. Leaving, guests see a car wreck in the…
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter III"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.

10. Where and when does “Chapter III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

**Inferential / analytical**

1. Why are the rumours about Gatsby so wild? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: His mystery invites projection.
2. What do the car wreck and Jordan's driving suggest? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Carelessness that will later kill.
3. What does “Chapter III” suggest about Gatsby's party? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The party presents Gatsby through rumour and spectacle before revealing the man, and links carelessness (driving, honesty) to the novel's moral concerns.
4. Find one example of imagery in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
5. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about Gatsby's party? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. On characterization: Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “By seven o’clock the orchestra has arrived, no thin five-piece affair, but a whole pitful of oboes and trombones and saxophones and viols and cornets and piccolos, and low and…”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Nick receives a formal invitation to one of Gatsby's parties, where hundreds of uninvited guests drink, dance and gossip about the host. With Jordan he meets the owl-eyed man in the library, amazed that the books are real. Nick talks with a young man who turns out to be Gatsby, with his reassuring…
8. How does “Chapter III” build on “Chapter II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76): Gatsby's charm. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever

known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171): Nick's self-assessment. On characterization: Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. The bell-ringer asked: “What do big parties reveal about the people who throw them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Gatsby's party joyful or empty? Use details. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: An evaluation of the imagery.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Does Nick's claim 'I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known' convince you? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned judgment.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76): Gatsby's charm. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “The party presents Gatsby through rumour and spectacle before revealing the man, and links carelessness (driving, honesty) to the novel's moral concerns.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171): Nick's self-assessment. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. On characterization: Gatsby's smile, "one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it," and his formal "old sport." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter III” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Gatsby's party? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76): Gatsby's charm. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171): Nick's self-assessment. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Connect this chapter to illusion and reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Is the imagery in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “It was one of those rare smiles with a quality of eternal reassurance in it” (Chapter III, paragraph 76): Gatsby's charm. On imagery: Gatsby's party in sensory overload: "In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Compare how “Chapter III” treats Gatsby's party with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known” (Chapter III, paragraph 171): Nick's self-assessment. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter IV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's parties are a performance that attracts people without making real connections. Useful evidence: “In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): The party as a dream, guests as moths to a light. Theme link: the owl-eyed man is amazed that Gatsby's books are real; the man himself is the illusion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

### *Chapter quiz*

1. How is Nick invited?
   A. By phone
   B. He is not invited
   C. By Daisy
   D. A formal note delivered by a chauffeur
2. What surprises the owl-eyed man?
   A. The champagne
   B. Gatsby is young
   C. The books are real
   D. The orchestra
3. What does Gatsby call people?
   A. My friend
   B. Sir
   C. Mate
   D. Old sport
4. What happens as guests leave?
   A. Gatsby gives a speech
   B. A fight breaks out
   C. A car crashes into a ditch
   D. It rains
5. What does Nick say about Jordan's honesty?
   A. She never lies
   B. She is wise

C. She is shy

D. She is incurably dishonest

6. In the line “We were sitting at a table with a man of about my age and a rowdy little girl, who gave way upon the slightest provocation to uncontrollable laughter.”, what does “uncontrollable” most nearly mean?

A. the time period between dawn and noon

B. difficult to solve or alleviate

C. consider bad or wrong

D. hang freely

7. In the line “I liked to walk up Fifth Avenue and pick out romantic women from the crowd and imagine that in a few minutes I was going to enter into their lives, and no one would ever know or disapprove.”, what does “disapprove” most nearly mean?

A. the time period between dawn and noon

B. difficult to solve or alleviate

C. consider bad or wrong

D. hang freely

**Answer key:** 1. D (A formal note delivered by a chauffeur); 2. C (The books are real); 3. D (Old sport); 4. C (A car crashes into a ditch); 5. D (She is incurably dishonest); 6. B (difficult to solve or alleviate); 7. C (consider bad or wrong)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter III,” how does Fitzgerald show Gatsby's party? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter III, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of Gatsby's party? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of Gatsby's party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of Gatsby's party. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter III suggests about Gatsby's party. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses imagery in Chapter III to complicate the reader's understanding of Gatsby's party. Develop

a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Gatsby's party responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Gatsby's party follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter III and its treatment of Gatsby's party. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's imagery and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter III as evidence for a larger claim about Gatsby's party in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Gatsby's party. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *Then, very gradually, part by part, a pale, dangling individual stepped out of the wreck, pawing tentatively at the ground with a large uncertain dancing shoe.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “dangling” most nearly mean?

   A. hang freely

   B. drifting on water

   C. direct toward itself or oneself by means of some psychological power or physical attributes

   D. an activity that is diverting and that holds the attention

2. *By seven o’clock the orchestra has arrived, no thin five-piece affair, but a whole pitful of oboes and trombones and saxophones and viols and cornets and piccolos, and low and high drums. The last swimmers have come in from the beach now and are dressing upstairs; the cars from New York are parked five deep in the drive, and already the halls and salons and verandas are gaudy with primary colours, and hair bobbed in strange new ways, and shawls beyond the dreams of Castile. The bar is in full swing, and floating rounds of cocktails permeate the garden outside, until the air is alive with chatter and laughter, and casual innuendo and*

*introductions forgotten on the spot, and enthusiastic meetings between women who never knew each other's names.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter III"?

A. The reunion

B. James Gatz and the second party

C. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

D. Gatsby's party

**SAT key:** 1. A (hang freely); 2. D (Gatsby's party)

# Lesson 5: Chapter IV

**Focus:** Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

**Content note (antisemitic stereotyping (narration)):** Wolfshiem is drawn with period antisemitic stereotypes. Discuss them openly as part of the novel's 1920s prejudices.
**Student preview:** The novel describes a Jewish character with stereotypes common in the 1920s.
**Suggested language:** "How does the novel's portrait of Wolfshiem reflect its time?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Gatsby drives Nick to the city, telling him a polished life story (Oxford, wealthy dead parents, war medals) and showing proof. At lunch he introduces Meyer Wolfshiem, who fixed the 1919 World Series. Jordan then tells Nick that in 1917 in Louisville, Daisy loved a young officer named Gatsby; she married Tom in 1919 after a night of crying over a letter. Gatsby bought his house to be across the bay from Daisy and wants Nick to invite her to tea.

**Background:** The 1919 World Series fix (the Black Sox scandal) was a real event. Camp Taylor near Louisville trained officers in 1917–18.

**Significance:** The chapter shifts from mystery to motive: Gatsby's wealth and parties serve one aim, Daisy.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Why might someone invent a past? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the American Dream because.... Content note before we start: The novel describes a Jewish character with stereotypes common in the 1920s.*
**Prompt:** Why might someone invent a past?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to the American Dream because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: starlight — the light of the stars; engrossed — devote (oneself) fully to; coincidence — an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental; struggles — an energetic attempt to achieve something; breeding — manners shown by one's upbringing.*
**Words:** starlight: the light of the stars · engrossed: devote (oneself) fully to · coincidence: an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental · struggles: an energetic attempt to achieve something · breeding: manners shown by one's upbringing

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*The 1919 World Series fix (the Black Sox scandal) was a real event. Camp Taylor near Louisville trained officers in 1917–18. The chapter shifts from mystery to motive: Gatsby's wealth and parties serve one aim, Daisy. Characterization: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world. Structure: Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville. Symbolism: The green light reinterpreted: Gatsby bought his house to be across the bay from Daisy. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "down behind many layers of glass in a sort of green leather conservatory, we started to town" (Chapter IV, paragraph 17).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now" (Chapter IV, paragraph 24). Gatsby's invented past. That is characterization at work: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world.*

> *I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now* (Chapter IV, paragraph 24)

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now" (Chapter IV, paragraph 24). Gatsby's invented past. That is characterization at work: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Nick divides people into pursued, pursuing, busy and tired. Expected link: the American Dream; Gatsby is the pursuer. Ask: How does this line connect to the American Dream? Expected: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. (Nick's summing-up.)*

> *There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired* (Chapter IV, paragraph 166)

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Nick divides people into pursued, pursuing, busy and tired. Expected link: the American Dream; Gatsby is the pursuer.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to the American Dream?
**Expected answer:** Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. (Nick's summing-up.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. When the text says "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay" (Chapter IV, paragraph 153), it shows this directly. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. When the text says "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay" (Chapter IV, paragraph 153), it shows this directly. His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: Why might someone invent a past? Ask: does knowing Gatsby's motive make him more or less admirable?*
**Anchor question:** Why might someone invent a past?
**Facilitation:** Ask: does knowing Gatsby's motive make him more or less admirable?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. ("Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay", Chapter IV, paragraph 153). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. ("Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay", Chapter IV, paragraph 153). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Key takeaway: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world.
- **Structure:** Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville.
- **Symbolism:** The green light reinterpreted: Gatsby bought his house to be across the bay from Daisy.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **the American Dream:** Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “down behind many layers of glass in a sort of green leather conservatory, we started to town” (Chapter IV, paragraph 17).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “I see” (Chapter IV, paragraph 28).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24) Gatsby's invented past.
- “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113) Wolfshiem.
- “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153) The reason for everything.
- “There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired” (Chapter IV, paragraph 166) Nick's summing-up.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal.
**Evidence:** “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153)
**Reasoning:** His story ("the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now") is suspect, his associate is "the man who fixed the World's Series," but Jordan explains that "Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay."

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **starlight** (noun) | the light of the stars | *He had waited five years and bought a mansion where he dispensed starlight to casual moths—so that he could "come over" some afternoon to a stranger's garden.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **engrossed** (verb) | devote (oneself) fully to | *They were so engrossed in each other that she didn't see me until I was five feet away.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **coincidence** (noun) | an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental | *"But it wasn't a coincidence at all."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **struggles** (noun) | an energetic attempt to achieve something | *The smile comprehended Montenegro's troubled history and sympathized with the brave struggles of the Montenegrin people.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **breeding** (noun) | manners shown by one's upbringing | *But I knew I had discovered a man of fine breeding after I talked with him an hour.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **deserves** (verb) | be worthy or deserving | *A little overwhelmed, I began the generalized evasions which that question deserves.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **triumphant** (adjective) | joyful and proud especially because of triumph or success | *It was a rich cream colour, bright with nickel, swollen here and there in its monstrous length with triumphant hatboxes and supper-boxes and toolboxes, and terraced with a labyrinth of windshields that mirrored a dozen suns.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **sixteen** (noun) | the cardinal number that is the sum of fifteen and one | *We stayed there two days and two nights, a hundred and thirty men with sixteen Lewis guns, and when the infantry came up at last they found the insignia of three German divisions among the piles of dead.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **admired** (verb) | feel admiration for | *I was flattered that she wanted to speak to me, because of all the older girls I admired her most.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bizarre** (adjective) | conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual | *So he was aware of the bizarre accusations that flavoured conversation in his halls.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Why might someone invent a past?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with illusion and reality?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Wolfshiem wear as cuff buttons? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Human molars.
2. When did Daisy marry Tom? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: June 1919.
3. What does Gatsby claim about his family? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Wealthy people in the Middle West, all dead
4. Who is Meyer Wolfshiem? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A gambler who fixed the World Series
5. Where did Daisy meet Gatsby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Louisville
6. Why did Gatsby buy his house? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To be across the bay from Daisy
7. What does Gatsby want from Nick? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To invite Daisy to tea
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby drives Nick to the city, telling him a polished life story (Oxford, wealthy dead parents, war medals) and showing proof. At lunch he introduces Meyer Wolfshiem, who fixed the 1919 World Series. Jordan then tells Nick that in 1917 in Louisville, Daisy loved a young officer named Gatsby; she married Tom in 1919 after a night of crying over a letter. Gatsby bought his house to be across the…
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter IV"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Gatsby show Nick a medal and a photograph? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To make his story believable, suggesting doubt.
2. How does Jordan's story change our view of Gatsby? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: His display becomes a romantic quest.
3. What does "Chapter IV" suggest about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The chapter shifts from mystery to motive: Gatsby's wealth and parties serve one aim, Daisy.

4. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. How does the structure in this chapter shape what we understand about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24): Gatsby's invented past. On structure: Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “I’d seen it.”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby drives Nick to the city, telling him a polished life story (Oxford, wealthy dead parents, war medals) and showing proof. At lunch he introduces Meyer Wolfshiem, who fixed the 1919 World Series. Jordan then tells Nick that in 1917 in Louisville, Daisy loved a young officer named Gatsby; she…
8. How does “Chapter IV” build on “Chapter III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113): Wolfshiem. On structure: Jordan narrates the backstory of Gatsby and Daisy in 1917 in Louisville. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153): The reason for everything. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone invent a past?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is Gatsby a romantic hero or a con man after this chapter? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned position.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired”

(Chapter IV, paragraph 166): Nick's summing-up. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Why does Fitzgerald let Jordan tell this backstory instead of Gatsby? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A view of structure and reliability.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24): Gatsby's invented past. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. A critic might argue: “The chapter shifts from mystery to motive: Gatsby's wealth and parties serve one aim, Daisy.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113): Wolfshiem. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153): The reason for everything. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter IV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired” (Chapter IV, paragraph 166): Nick's summing-up. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24): Gatsby's invented past. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to carelessness and morality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “He’s the man who fixed the World’s Series back in 1919” (Chapter IV, paragraph 113): Wolfshiem. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “Gatsby bought that house so that Daisy would be just across the bay” (Chapter IV, paragraph 153): The reason for everything. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick an implausible life story; Wolfshiem, "the man who fixed the World's Series," shows the criminal side of his world. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Compare how “Chapter IV” treats Gatsby's story and Daisy's past with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “There are only the pursued, the pursuing, the busy, and the tired” (Chapter IV, paragraph 166): Nick's summing-up. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Predict what “Chapter V” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Chapter IV reveals that Gatsby's grand life is organized around one goal. Useful evidence: “I am the son of some wealthy people in the Middle West—all dead now” (Chapter IV, paragraph 24): Gatsby's invented past. Theme link: Gatsby's self-invention mixes fact and fiction. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Structure**: how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What does Gatsby claim about his family?

   A. Wealthy people in the Middle West, all dead

B. Poor farmers

C. Royalty

D. Bankers in New York

2. Who is Meyer Wolfshiem?

A. A golfer

B. Daisy's father

C. A gambler who fixed the World Series

D. A senator

3. Where did Daisy meet Gatsby?

A. Louisville

B. Chicago

C. Oxford

D. New York

4. Why did Gatsby buy his house?

A. For his father

B. For parties

C. To be across the bay from Daisy

D. As an investment

5. What does Gatsby want from Nick?

A. A job

B. A lie

C. A loan

D. To invite Daisy to tea

6. In the line "He had waited five years and bought a mansion where he dispensed starlight to casual moths—so that he could "come over" some afternoon to a stranger's garden.", what does "starlight" most nearly mean?

A. an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental

B. the light of the stars

C. devote (oneself) fully to

D. an energetic attempt to achieve something

7. In the line "They were so engrossed in each other that she didn't see me until I was five feet away.", what does "engrossed" most nearly mean?

A. the light of the stars

B. an energetic attempt to achieve something

C. devote (oneself) fully to

D. an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental

**Answer key:** 1. A (Wealthy people in the Middle West, all dead); 2. C (A gambler who fixed the World Series); 3. A (Louisville); 4. C (To be across the bay from Daisy); 5. D (To invite Daisy to tea); 6. B (the light of the stars); 7. C (devote (oneself) fully to)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter IV,” how does Fitzgerald show Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter IV, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IV suggests about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and structure), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses characterization in Chapter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IV and its treatment of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and structure, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IV as evidence for a larger claim about Gatsby's story and Daisy's past in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Gatsby's story and Daisy's past. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *"But it wasn't a coincidence at all."*

   As used in the text, what does the word "coincidence" most nearly mean?

   A. conspicuously or grossly unconventional or unusual

   B. the cardinal number that is the sum of fifteen and one

   C. feel admiration for

   D. an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental

2. *I'd seen it. Everybody had seen it. It was a rich cream colour, bright with nickel, swollen here and there in its monstrous length with triumphant hatboxes and supper-boxes and toolboxes, and terraced with a labyrinth of windshields that mirrored a dozen suns. Sitting down behind many layers of glass in a sort of green leather conservatory, we started to town.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IV"?

   A. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

   B. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

   C. The Plaza and the death car

   D. Gatsby's story and Daisy's past

**SAT key:** 1. D (an event that might have been arranged although it was really accidental); 2. D (Gatsby's story and Daisy's past)

# Lesson 6: Chapter V

**Focus:** the reunion

Teacher only · spoilers

Gatsby has Nick's lawn cut and fills his cottage with flowers. The reunion begins in painful awkwardness, then after half an hour Daisy and Gatsby are radiant. Gatsby shows Daisy his mansion and throws his shirts before her; she sobs. He mentions the green light at the end of her dock. Klipspringer plays the piano. Nick leaves them together, sensing that Daisy cannot match Gatsby's dream.

**Background:** Imported English shirts and mansions copying European styles were status symbols for the newly rich.

**Significance:** The dream meets reality, and the green light loses its 'colossal significance.'

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to illusion and reality because....*
**Prompt:** What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to illusion and reality because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion."

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: fluctuating — rising and falling; changing again and again; intruding — coming in where one is not wanted; bedrooms — a room used primarily for sleeping; luckily — by good fortune; murmurs — quiet complaints.*
*"fluctuating": From Latin fluctuare "to move in waves," from fluctus "a wave," from fluere "to flow."*
**Words:** fluctuating: rising and falling; changing again and again · intruding: coming in where one is not wanted · bedrooms: a room used primarily for sleeping · luckily: by good fortune · murmurs: quiet complaints

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Imported English shirts and mansions copying European styles were status symbols for the newly rich. The dream meets reality, and the green light loses its 'colossal significance.' Structure: The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy. Symbolism: Gatsby's shirts: Daisy cries over them, overwhelmed by wealth as display. Imagery: The green light's "colossal significance" vanishes once Daisy is near. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "and the whole corner of the peninsula was blazing with light, which fell unreal on the shrubbery and made thin elongating glints" (Chapter V, paragraph 1).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "They're such beautiful shirts" (Chapter V, paragraph 118). Daisy's tears over the shirts. That is structure at work: The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy.*

> *They're such beautiful shirts* (Chapter V, paragraph 118)

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "They're such beautiful shirts" (Chapter V, paragraph 118). Daisy's tears over the shirts. That is structure at work: The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Once Daisy is beside him, the light is only a light. Expected link: illusion and reality. Ask: How does this line connect to illusion and reality? Expected: No real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." (The dream shrinks when reached.)*

> *the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever* (Chapter V, paragraph 121)

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Once Daisy is beside him, the light is only a light. Expected link: illusion and reality.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to illusion and reality?
**Expected answer:** No real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." (The dream shrinks when reached.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for structure, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the reunion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of the reunion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. When the text says “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121), it shows this directly. Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts."*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for structure, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the reunion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of the reunion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. When the text says “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121), it shows this directly. Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time? Ask: why does Daisy cry over the shirts?*
**Anchor question:** What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time?
**Facilitation:** Ask: why does Daisy cry over the shirts?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the reunion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. (“the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever”, Chapter V, paragraph 121). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the reunion? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. (“the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever”, Chapter V, paragraph 121). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how structure shapes the reunion. Key takeaway: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion."*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Structure:** The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy.
- **Symbolism:** Gatsby's shirts: Daisy cries over them, overwhelmed by wealth as display.
- **Imagery:** The green light's "colossal significance" vanishes once Daisy is near.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **illusion and reality:** no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion."

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “and the whole corner of the peninsula was blazing with light, which fell unreal on the shrubbery and made thin elongating glints” (Chapter V, paragraph 1).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “Does it?” He turned his eyes toward it absently. “I have been glancing into some of the” (Chapter V, paragraph 4).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118) Daisy's tears over the shirts.
- “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121) The dream shrinks when reached.
- “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151) Reality versus illusion.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself.
**Evidence:** “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121)
**Reasoning:** Nick notes that "the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever" and that "Daisy tumbled short of his dreams," while Daisy weeps over "such beautiful shirts."

## *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **fluctuating** (verb) | rising and falling; changing again and again | *I think that voice held him most, with its fluctuating, feverish warmth, because it couldn’t be over-dreamed—that voice was a deathless song.* | “fluctuating”: From Latin fluctuare "to move in waves," from fluctus "a wave," from fluere "to flow." (Online |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/fluctuate) |
| **intruding** (verb) | coming in where one is not wanted | *We went upstairs, through period bedrooms swathed in rose and lavender silk and vivid with new flowers, through dressing-rooms and poolrooms, and bathrooms with sunken baths—intruding into one chamber where a dishevelled man in pyjamas was doing liver exercises on the floor.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bedrooms** (noun) | a room used primarily for sleeping | *We went upstairs, through period bedrooms swathed in rose and lavender silk and vivid with new flowers, through dressing-rooms and poolrooms, and bathrooms with sunken baths—intruding into one chamber where a dishevelled man in pyjamas was doing liver exercises on the floor.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **luckily** (adverb) | by good fortune | *"You're just embarrassed, that's all," and luckily I added: "Daisy's embarrassed too."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **murmurs** (noun) | quiet complaints | *With enchanting murmurs Daisy admired this aspect or that of the feudal silhouette against the sky, admired the gardens, the sparkling odour of jonquils and the frothy odour of hawthorn and plum blossoms and the pale gold odour of kiss-me-at-the-gate.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **calmness** (noun) | steadiness of mind under stress | *However, as calmness wasn't an end in itself, I made an excuse at the first possible moment, and got to my feet.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **interrupt** (verb) | to break in on; to stop | *"Did we interrupt your exercise?" inquired Daisy politely.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **embarrassed** (verb) | cause to be embarrassed; cause to feel self-conscious | *"You're just embarrassed, that's all," and luckily I added: "Daisy's embarrassed too."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ghostly** (adjective) | resembling or characteristic of a phantom | *I could have sworn I heard the owl-eyed man break into ghostly laughter.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **politely** (adverb) | in a polite manner | *"Did we interrupt your exercise?" inquired Daisy politely.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time?
2. Where does structure appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with carelessness and morality?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What does Gatsby do to Nick's lawn? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Sends a man to cut it.
2. What did Gatsby keep about Daisy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Newspaper clippings.
3. Where does the reunion take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Nick's house
4. What is the weather during the reunion? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Rain
5. What makes Daisy cry? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby's shirts
6. Who plays the piano? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Klipspringer
7. What nearly falls during the awkward meeting? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A clock
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby has Nick's lawn cut and fills his cottage with flowers. The reunion begins in painful awkwardness, then after half an hour Daisy and Gatsby are radiant. Gatsby shows Daisy his mansion and throws his shirts before her; she sobs. He mentions the green light at the end of her dock. Klipspringer plays the piano. Nick leaves them together, sensing that Daisy cannot match Gatsby's dream.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter V"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter V" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the near-falling clock matter? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Gatsby tries to stop time; it is a symbol of the past.
2. Why does the green light lose its meaning? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Daisy is near; the symbol becomes an object.

3. What does “Chapter V” suggest about the reunion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The dream meets reality, and the green light loses its 'colossal significance.'
4. Find one example of structure in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
5. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the reunion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. On symbolism: Gatsby's shirts: Daisy cries over them, overwhelmed by wealth as display. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “Amid the welcome confusion of cups and cakes a certain physical decency established itself.”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby has Nick's lawn cut and fills his cottage with flowers. The reunion begins in painful awkwardness, then after half an hour Daisy and Gatsby are radiant. Gatsby shows Daisy his mansion and throws his shirts before her; she sobs. He mentions the green light at the end of her dock. Klipspringer…
8. How does “Chapter V” build on “Chapter IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121): The dream shrinks when reached. On structure: The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151): Reality versus illusion. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens when you finally get something you wanted for a long time?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Can any real person match a five-year dream? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Is Gatsby's display of wealth love or performance? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: An evaluation.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121): The dream shrinks when reached. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “The dream meets reality, and the green light loses its 'colossal significance.'” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151): Reality versus illusion. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter V” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the reunion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121): The dream shrinks when reached. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than

the woman herself. Useful evidence: “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151): Reality versus illusion. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to the American Dream: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the structure in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “the colossal significance of that light had now vanished forever” (Chapter V, paragraph 121): The dream shrinks when reached. On structure: The reunion at Nick's cottage moves from awkward silence to rain, tears and joy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter V” treats the reunion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “There must have been moments even that afternoon when Daisy tumbled short of his dreams” (Chapter V, paragraph 151): Reality versus illusion. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter VI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The reunion shows that Gatsby's dream is larger than the woman herself. Useful evidence: “They’re such beautiful shirts” (Chapter V, paragraph 118): Daisy's tears over the shirts. Theme link: no real woman can match "the colossal vitality of his illusion." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Structure:** look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Where does the reunion take place?
   A. Nick's house
   B. Gatsby's mansion
   C. The Plaza
   D. Daisy's house
2. What is the weather during the reunion?
   A. Rain
   B. Fog
   C. Heat wave
   D. Snow
3. What makes Daisy cry?
   A. Tom's call
   B. A letter
   C. Gatsby's shirts
   D. The piano
4. Who plays the piano?
   A. Wolfshiem
   B. Klipspringer
   C. Nick
   D. Jordan
5. What nearly falls during the awkward meeting?
   A. A glass
   B. A chair
   C. A clock
   D. A vase
6. In the line “I think that voice held him most, with its fluctuating, feverish warmth, because it couldn’t be over-dreamed—that voice was a deathless song.”, what does “fluctuating” most nearly mean?
   A. by good fortune
   B. rising and falling; changing again and again
   C. a room used primarily for sleeping
   D. coming in where one is not wanted
7. In the line “We went upstairs, through period bedrooms swathed in rose and lavender silk and vivid with new flowers, through dressing-rooms and poolrooms, and bathrooms with sunken baths—intruding into one chamber where a dishevelled man in pyjamas was doing liver exercises on the floor.”, what does “intruding” most nearly mean?
   A. by good fortune
   B. a room used primarily for sleeping
   C. rising and falling; changing again and again

D. coming in where one is not wanted

**Answer key:** 1. A (Nick's house); 2. A (Rain); 3. C (Gatsby's shirts); 4. B (Klipspringer); 5. C (A clock); 6. B (rising and falling; changing again and again); 7. D (coming in where one is not wanted)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter V," how does Fitzgerald show the reunion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter V, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of the reunion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of the reunion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the reunion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter V suggests about the reunion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's structure and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses structure in Chapter V to complicate the reader's understanding of the reunion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter V within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the reunion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the reunion follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter V and its treatment of the reunion.

State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's structure and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter V as evidence for a larger claim about the reunion in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter V as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the reunion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *We went upstairs, through period bedrooms swathed in rose and lavender silk and vivid with new flowers, through dressing-rooms and poolrooms, and bathrooms with sunken baths—intruding into one chamber where a dishevelled man in pyjamas was doing liver exercises on the floor.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “bedrooms” most nearly mean?

   A. cause to be embarrassed; cause to feel self-conscious

   B. in a polite manner

   C. resembling or characteristic of a phantom

   D. a room used primarily for sleeping

2. *Amid the welcome confusion of cups and cakes a certain physical decency established itself. Gatsby got himself into a shadow and, while Daisy and I talked, looked conscientiously from one to the other of us with tense, unhappy eyes. However, as calmness wasn’t an end in itself, I made an excuse at the first possible moment, and got to my feet.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter V”?

   A. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

   B. The reunion

   C. Gatsby's party

   D. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

**SAT key:** 1. D (a room used primarily for sleeping); 2. B (The reunion)

# Lesson 7: Chapter VI

**Focus:** James Gatz and the second party

Teacher only · spoilers

Nick reveals Gatsby's past: James Gatz of North Dakota, who at seventeen reinvented himself after meeting the millionaire Dan Cody and served him for five years. Tom visits Gatsby's house with others and is rude. At the next party Daisy is uneasy and dislikes West Egg. Afterward Gatsby tells Nick he wants Daisy to tell Tom she never loved him and to repeat the past by marrying in Louisville.

**Background:** Copper and mining fortunes made men like Dan Cody rich; self-made success stories (Horatio Alger) were popular.

**Significance:** Gatsby's invention and his belief in repeating the past drive the tragedy.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*Can people really reinvent themselves? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the past and time because....*
**Prompt:** Can people really reinvent themselves?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to the past and time because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: transpired — became known; dilatory — slow; tending to delay; shiftless — lazy and lacking ambition; blossomed — developed; grew and flourished; elusive — hard to grasp, catch or put into words.*
**Words:** transpired: became known · dilatory: slow; tending to delay · shiftless: lazy and lacking ambition · blossomed: developed; grew and flourished · elusive: hard to grasp, catch or put into words

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Copper and mining fortunes made men like Dan Cody rich; self-made success stories (Horatio Alger) were popular. Gatsby's invention and his belief in repeating the past drive the tragedy. Characterization: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody. Diction / vocabulary: "his Platonic conception of himself": an ideal self-creation. Conflict: Tom comes to a party; Daisy is unhappy there. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “been loafing along the beach that afternoon in a torn green jersey and a pair of canvas pants, but it was already” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). Gatsby's real name. That is characterization at work: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody.*

> *James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name* *(Chapter VI, paragraph 6)*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" (Chapter VI, paragraph 6). Gatsby's real name. That is characterization at work: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Platonic here means an ideal form; Gatsby invented an ideal version of himself. Expected link: the American Dream. Ask: How does this line connect to the past and time? Expected: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. (Self-invention.)*

> *sprang from his Platonic conception of himself* *(Chapter VI, paragraph 7)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Platonic here means an ideal form; Gatsby invented an ideal version of himself. Expected link: the American Dream.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to the past and time?
**Expected answer:** Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. (Self-invention.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about James Gatz and the second party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of James Gatz and the second party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. When the text says “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!"*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about James Gatz and the second party? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of James Gatz and the second party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. When the text says “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!"

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: Can people really reinvent themselves? Ask: can anyone repeat the past?*

**Anchor question:** Can people really reinvent themselves?

**Facilitation:** Ask: can anyone repeat the past?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about James Gatz and the second party? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. (“James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name”, Chapter VI, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*

**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about James Gatz and the second party? Support it with one short quotation.

**Answer:** Model answer: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. (“James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name”, Chapter VI, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes James Gatz and the second party. Key takeaway: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "his Platonic conception of himself": an ideal self-creation.
- **Conflict:** Tom comes to a party; Daisy is unhappy there.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **the past and time:** Gatsby insists he can repeat the past.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “been loafing along the beach that afternoon in a torn green jersey and a pair of canvas pants, but it was already” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “off and with laudable initiative he had hurried out “to see” (Chapter VI, paragraph 4).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6) Gatsby's real name.
- “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7) Self-invention.
- “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128) Nick's warning.
- “Why of course you can” (Chapter VI, paragraph 129) Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention.
**Evidence:** “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6)
**Reasoning:** Nick reveals "James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name" and that Gatsby "sprang from his Platonic conception of himself," which explains his answer to Nick's "You can't repeat the past": "Why of course you can!"

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **transpired** (verb) | became known | *It transpired after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby's name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn't reveal or didn't fully understand.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dilatory** (adjective) | slow; tending to delay | *The dilatory limousine came rolling up the drive.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **shiftless** (adjective) | lazy and lacking ambition | *His parents were shiftless and unsuccessful farm people—his imagination had never really accepted them as his parents at all.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **blossomed** (verb) | developed; grew and flourished | *At his lips' touch she blossomed for him like a flower and the incarnation was complete.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **elusive** (adjective) | hard to grasp, catch or put into words | *Through all he said, even through his appalling sentimentality, I was reminded of something—an elusive rhythm, a fragment of lost words, that I had heard somewhere a long time ago.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **mumbled** (verb) | talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice | *"Anything I hate is to get my head stuck in a pool," mumbled Miss Baedeker.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **incarnation** (noun) | a lifetime in a particular body | *At his lips' touch she blossomed for him like a flower and the incarnation was complete.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **newspaper** (noun) | a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements | *The none too savoury ramifications by which Ella Kaye, the newspaper woman, played Madame de Maintenon to his weakness and sent him to sea in a yacht, were common property of the turgid journalism in 1902.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dismissed** (verb) | sent away; released | *He dismissed all the dances he had given with a snap of his fingers.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **ghostly** (adjective) | resembling or characteristic of a phantom | *Tom and Daisy stared, with that peculiarly unreal feeling that accompanies the recognition of a hitherto ghostly celebrity of the movies.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. Can people really reinvent themselves?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the American Dream?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. What did Gatsby inherit from Cody? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Nothing; the legacy was taken by Ella Kaye.
2. Who comes with Tom to Gatsby's? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Mr. Sloane and a woman.
3. What was Gatsby's real name? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: James Gatz
4. Who mentored Gatsby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Dan Cody
5. Where did Gatsby grow up? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: North Dakota
6. How does Daisy feel at the party? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Uneasy and unimpressed
7. What does Gatsby want Daisy to say to Tom? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She never loved him
8. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter VI” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Nick reveals Gatsby's past: James Gatz of North Dakota, who at seventeen reinvented himself after meeting the millionaire Dan Cody and served him for five years. Tom visits Gatsby's house with others and is rude. At the next party Daisy is uneasy and dislikes West Egg. Afterward Gatsby tells Nick he wants Daisy to tell Tom she never loved him and to repeat the past by marrying in Louisville.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter VI”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does “Chapter VI” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

#### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Gatsby insist on repeating the past? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He wants to recover himself as well as Daisy.
2. What does Daisy dislike about West Egg? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Its raw vigor and lack of polish.

3. What does “Chapter VI” suggest about James Gatz and the second party? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Gatsby's invention and his belief in repeating the past drive the tragedy.
4. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. How does the diction / vocabulary in this chapter shape what we understand about James Gatz and the second party? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6): Gatsby's real name. On diction / vocabulary: "his Platonic conception of himself": an ideal self-creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins “It transpired after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby’s name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn’t reveal or didn’t fully understand.”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Nick reveals Gatsby's past: James Gatz of North Dakota, who at seventeen reinvented himself after meeting the millionaire Dan Cody and served him for five years. Tom visits Gatsby's house with others and is rude. At the next party Daisy is uneasy and dislikes West Egg. Afterward Gatsby tells Nick…
8. How does “Chapter VI” build on “Chapter V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7): Self-invention. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128): Nick's warning. On characterization: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “Can people really reinvent themselves?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is self-invention admirable or dangerous in Gatsby's case? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned evaluation.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “Why of course you can” (Chapter VI, paragraph 129): Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Should Nick have told us Gatsby's true history earlier? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: An argument about structure.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6): Gatsby's real name. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. A critic might argue: “Gatsby's invention and his belief in repeating the past drive the tragedy.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7): Self-invention. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128): Nick's warning. On characterization: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about James Gatz and the second party? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “Why of course you can” (Chapter VI, paragraph 129): Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6): Gatsby's real name. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to class and money: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “sprang from his Platonic conception of himself” (Chapter VI, paragraph 7): Self-invention. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “You can’t repeat the past” (Chapter VI, paragraph 128): Nick's warning. On characterization: Nick tells Gatsby's real origins: James Gatz from North Dakota, shaped by Dan Cody. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Compare how “Chapter VI” treats James Gatz and the second party with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “Why of course you can” (Chapter VI, paragraph 129): Gatsby's reply, "incredulously": he rejects the limits of time. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Predict what “Chapter VII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Gatsby's belief that he can repeat the past grows from his self-invention. Useful evidence: “James Gatz—that was really, or at least legally, his name” (Chapter VI, paragraph 6): Gatsby's real name. Theme link: Gatsby insists he can repeat the past. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

### *Chapter quiz*

1. What was Gatsby's real name?
   A. Jim Carraway
   B. Gus Gatz

C. Jay Cody

D. James Gatz

2. Who mentored Gatsby?

A. Dan Cody

B. Tom Buchanan

C. Nick's father

D. Meyer Wolfshiem

3. Where did Gatsby grow up?

A. New York

B. Kentucky

C. Chicago

D. North Dakota

4. How does Daisy feel at the party?

A. Bored but happy

B. Angry at Nick

C. Thrilled

D. Uneasy and unimpressed

5. What does Gatsby want Daisy to say to Tom?

A. Goodbye

B. Sorry

C. She never loved him

D. She is leaving

6. In the line "It transpired after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby's name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn't reveal or didn't fully understand.", what does "transpired" most nearly mean?

A. slow; tending to delay

B. developed; grew and flourished

C. lazy and lacking ambition

D. became known

7. In the line "The dilatory limousine came rolling up the drive.", what does "dilatory" most nearly mean?

A. became known

B. lazy and lacking ambition

C. slow; tending to delay

D. developed; grew and flourished

**Answer key:** 1. D (James Gatz); 2. A (Dan Cody); 3. D (North Dakota); 4. D (Uneasy and unimpressed); 5. C (She never loved him); 6. D (became known); 7. C (slow; tending to delay)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VI,” how does Fitzgerald show James Gatz and the second party? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VI, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of James Gatz and the second party? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of James Gatz and the second party. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of James Gatz and the second party. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VI suggests about James Gatz and the second party. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses characterization in Chapter VI to complicate the reader's understanding of James Gatz and the second party. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of James Gatz and the second party responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of James Gatz and the second party follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VI and its treatment of James Gatz and the second party. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and diction / vocabulary, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VI as evidence for a larger claim about James Gatz and the second party in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of James Gatz and the second party. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *His parents were shiftless and unsuccessful farm people—his imagination had never really accepted them as his parents at all.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “shiftless” most nearly mean?

   A. lazy and lacking ambition

   B. sent away; released

   C. resembling or characteristic of a phantom

   D. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements

2. *It transpired after a confused five minutes that the man had heard Gatsby’s name around his office in a connection which he either wouldn’t reveal or didn’t fully understand. This was his day off and with laudable initiative he had hurried out “to see.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VI”?

   A. The Plaza and the death car

   B. The valley of ashes and Myrtle's party

   C. James Gatz and the second party

   D. The funeral and the meaning of the dream

**SAT key:** 1. A (lazy and lacking ambition); 2. C (James Gatz and the second party)

# Lesson 8: Chapter VII

**Focus:** the Plaza and the death car

**Content note (traffic death, graphic injury):** Myrtle is struck and killed by a car; her injuries are described in one graphic sentence. Present it briefly and move to the question of responsibility.
**Student preview:** A woman is killed by a car; one sentence describes her injuries.
**Suggested language:** "Who is responsible for Myrtle's death?"

Teacher only · spoilers

On the hottest day of summer Gatsby and Nick lunch with the Buchanans; Tom realizes Daisy loves Gatsby. They drive to the city, Tom in Gatsby's yellow car. At the Plaza, Tom exposes Gatsby's bootlegging; Daisy says she loved both. Driving home in Gatsby's car, Daisy hits Myrtle, who runs into the road, killing her. Gatsby waits outside the Buchanans' house; Nick sees Tom and Daisy conspiring.

**Background:** The Plaza Hotel on Fifth Avenue was a landmark of luxury. Tom's charge that Gatsby and Wolfshiem 'bought up a lot of side-street drug-stores' reflects a real Prohibition practice: pharmacies could sell alcohol on prescription and served as fronts for bootlegging. Cars were new and lightly regulated; traffic deaths rose sharply in the 1920s.

**Significance:** The climax: in one afternoon Gatsby's dream is exposed as resting on crime and on a past he cannot erase, and the car, the novel's symbol of status and danger, becomes a weapon. Responsibility for Myrtle's death begins to be shifted from the careless to the dreamer.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*How does heat raise tension? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to class and money because.... Content note before we start: A woman is killed by a car; one sentence describes her injuries.*
**Prompt:** How does heat raise tension?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to class and money because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: old money defeats new money.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: needlessly — without good reason; harrowing — deeply distressing; flirtation — playful behavior intended to arouse sexual interest; collapsed — break down, literally or metaphorically; sneering — express through a scornful smile.*
**Words:** needlessly: without good reason · harrowing: deeply distressing · flirtation: playful behavior intended to arouse sexual interest · collapsed: break down, literally or metaphorically · sneering: express through a scornful smile

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*The Plaza Hotel on Fifth Avenue was a landmark of luxury. Tom's charge that Gatsby and Wolfshiem 'bought up a lot of side-street drug-stores' reflects a real Prohibition practice: pharmacies could sell alcohol on prescription and served as fronts for bootlegging. Cars were new and lightly regulated; traffic deaths rose sharply in the 1920s. The climax: in one afternoon Gatsby's dream is exposed as resting on crime and on a past he cannot erase, and the car, the novel's symbol of status and danger, becomes a weapon. Responsibility for Myrtle's death begins to be shifted from the careless to the dreamer. Setting: The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation. Characterization: Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom. Symbolism: Daisy's voice "full of money." Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "I went with them out to the veranda. On the green Sound, stagnant in the heat, one small sail crawled slowly toward" (Chapter VII, paragraph 68).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I did love him once—but I loved you too" (Chapter VII, paragraph 263). Daisy's answer. That is setting at work: The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation.*

> *I did love him once—but I loved you too* (Chapter VII, paragraph 263)

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I did love him once—but I loved you too" (Chapter VII, paragraph 263). Daisy's answer. That is setting at work: The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Daisy's charm is the sound of wealth and security. Expected link: class and money. Ask: How does this line connect to class and money? Expected: Old money defeats new money. (Gatsby's insight about Daisy.)*

> *Her voice is full of money* (Chapter VII, paragraph 104)

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Daisy's charm is the sound of wealth and security. Expected link: class and money.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to class and money?
**Expected answer:** Old money defeats new money. (Gatsby's insight about Daisy.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the Plaza and the death car? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the Plaza and the death car. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. When the text says "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104), it shows this directly. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the Plaza and the death car? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the Plaza and the death car. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. When the text says "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104), it shows this directly. Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: How does heat raise tension? Who wins at the Plaza, and why?*
**Anchor question:** How does heat raise tension?
**Facilitation:** Who wins at the Plaza, and why?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the Plaza and the death car? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. ("Her voice is full of money", Chapter VII, paragraph 104). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the Plaza and the death car? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. ("Her voice is full of money", Chapter VII, paragraph 104). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how setting shapes the Plaza and the death car. Key takeaway: old money defeats new money.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Setting:** The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation.
- **Characterization:** Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom.
- **Symbolism:** Daisy's voice "full of money."

**Themes and how they develop**

- **class and money:** old money defeats new money.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “I went with them out to the veranda. On the green Sound, stagnant in the heat, one small sail crawled slowly toward” (Chapter VII, paragraph 68).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “in like a card house at the disapproval in her eyes” (Chapter VII, paragraph 15).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104) Gatsby's insight about Daisy.
- “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263) Daisy's answer.
- “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307) Nick's birthday reflection.
- “The “death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315) The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream.
**Evidence:** “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104)
**Reasoning:** Gatsby recognizes "Her voice is full of money," and Daisy's "I did love him once—but I loved you too" destroys his demand for total possession of the past.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **needlessly** (adverb) | without good reason | *“Madame expects you in the salon!” he cried, needlessly indicating the direction.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **harrowing** (adjective) | deeply distressing | | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *And yet I couldn't believe that they would choose this occasion for a scene—especially for the rather harrowing scene that Gatsby had outlined in the garden.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **flirtation** (noun) | playful behavior intended to arouse sexual interest | *I think he realizes that his presumptuous little flirtation is over."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **collapsed** (verb) | break down, literally or metaphorically | *Wilson's eyes fell upon Tom; he started up on his tiptoes and then would have collapsed to his knees had not Tom held him upright.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **sneering** (verb) | express through a scornful smile | *Well, if that's the idea you can count me out… Nowadays people begin by sneering at family life and family institutions, and next they'll throw everything overboard and have intermarriage between black and white."* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **wavered** (verb) | pause or hold back in uncertainty or unwillingness | *The "death car" as the newspapers called it, didn't stop; it came out of the gathering darkness, wavered tragically for a moment, and then disappeared around the next bend.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **developing** (verb) | growing; changing over time | *So engrossed was she that she had no consciousness of being observed, and one emotion after another crept into her face like objects into a slowly developing picture.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **indicating** (verb) | showing; pointing to | *"Madame expects you in the salon!" he cried, needlessly indicating the direction.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **engaging** (verb) | becoming engaged to marry | *And we all took the less explicable step of engaging the parlour of a suite in the Plaza Hotel.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **delayed** (verb) | cause to be slowed down or delayed | *Several times he turned his head and looked back for their car, and if the traffic delayed them he slowed up until they came into sight.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. How does heat raise tension?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with class and money?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. Why does Myrtle run into the road? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She thinks Tom is in the car.
2. What does Gatsby plan to say? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: That he was driving.
3. Where is the confrontation? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The Plaza Hotel
4. Whose car does Tom drive to the city? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby's
5. Who is driving when Myrtle is killed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Daisy
6. What does Tom reveal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby's illegal business
7. What birthday is it for Nick? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Thirtieth
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter VII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: On the hottest day of summer Gatsby and Nick lunch with the Buchanans; Tom realizes Daisy loves Gatsby. They drive to the city, Tom in Gatsby's yellow car. At the Plaza, Tom exposes Gatsby's bootlegging; Daisy says she loved both. Driving home in Gatsby's car, Daisy hits Myrtle, who runs into the road, killing her. Gatsby waits outside the Buchanans' house; Nick sees Tom and Daisy conspiring.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter VII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter VII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Daisy fail Gatsby at the Plaza? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She cannot deny the past with Tom.
2. What does Nick see through the window? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Tom and Daisy in intimacy.
3. What does "Chapter VII" suggest about the Plaza and the death car? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The climax: in one afternoon Gatsby's dream is exposed as resting on crime and on a past he cannot erase, and the car, the novel's symbol of status and danger, becomes a weapon. Responsibility for Myrtle's death begins to be shifted from the careless to the dreamer.
4. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
5. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the Plaza and the death car? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: "Her voice is full of money" (Chapter VII, paragraph 104): Gatsby's insight about Daisy. On characterization: Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that begins “He was calling up at Daisy’s request—would I come to lunch at her house tomorrow?”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: On the hottest day of summer Gatsby and Nick lunch with the Buchanans; Tom realizes Daisy loves Gatsby. They drive to the city, Tom in Gatsby's yellow car. At the Plaza, Tom exposes Gatsby's bootlegging; Daisy says she loved both. Driving home in Gatsby's car, Daisy hits Myrtle, who runs into the…
8. How does “Chapter VII” build on “Chapter VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263): Daisy's answer. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307): Nick's birthday reflection. On characterization: Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “How does heat raise tension?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Who is responsible for Myrtle's death? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned judgment.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “The “death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315): The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Is Daisy careless, trapped or both? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: An evaluation.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104): Gatsby's insight about Daisy. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. A critic might argue: “The climax: in one afternoon Gatsby's dream is exposed as resting on crime and on a past he cannot erase, and the car, the novel's symbol of status and danger, becomes a weapon. Responsibility for Myrtle's death begins to be shifted from…” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263): Daisy's answer. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307): Nick's birthday reflection. On characterization: Tom exposes Gatsby; Daisy cannot deny she loved Tom. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the Plaza and the death car? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “The “death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315): The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104): Gatsby's insight about Daisy. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to the past and time: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “I did love him once—but I loved you too” (Chapter VII, paragraph 263): Daisy's answer. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over

Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Thirty—the promise of a decade of loneliness” (Chapter VII, paragraph 307): Nick's birthday reflection. On setting: The hottest day of summer; the Plaza Hotel confrontation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter VII” treats the Plaza and the death car with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “The “death car” (Chapter VII, paragraph 315): The newspapers' name for the car that killed Myrtle; Nick's ironic quotation marks. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter VIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The Plaza confrontation shows old money's power over Gatsby's dream. Useful evidence: “Her voice is full of money” (Chapter VII, paragraph 104): Gatsby's insight about Daisy. Theme link: old money defeats new money. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Where is the confrontation?
   A. Nick's office
   B. Gatsby's house
   C. The valley of ashes
   D. The Plaza Hotel
2. Whose car does Tom drive to the city?
   A. Jordan's
   B. Nick's
   C. Gatsby's
   D. Wilson's
3. Who is driving when Myrtle is killed?
   A. Nick
   B. Daisy
   C. Tom

D. Gatsby

4. What does Tom reveal?
   A. His affair
   B. Gatsby's illegal business
   C. Daisy's letters
   D. His debts
5. What birthday is it for Nick?
   A. Thirtieth
   B. Twenty-first
   C. Fortieth
   D. Twenty-fifth
6. In the line ""Madame expects you in the salon!" he cried, needlessly indicating the direction.", what does "needlessly" most nearly mean?
   A. break down, literally or metaphorically
   B. playful behavior intended to arouse sexual interest
   C. deeply distressing
   D. without good reason
7. In the line "And yet I couldn't believe that they would choose this occasion for a scene—especially for the rather harrowing scene that Gatsby had outlined in the garden.", what does "harrowing" most nearly mean?
   A. without good reason
   B. break down, literally or metaphorically
   C. deeply distressing
   D. playful behavior intended to arouse sexual interest

**Answer key:** 1. D (The Plaza Hotel); 2. C (Gatsby's); 3. B (Daisy); 4. B (Gatsby's illegal business); 5. A (Thirtieth); 6. D (without good reason); 7. C (deeply distressing)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter VII," how does Fitzgerald show the Plaza and the death car? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VII, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of the Plaza and the death car? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the Plaza and the death car. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence,

and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the Plaza and the death car. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VII suggests about the Plaza and the death car. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses setting in Chapter VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the Plaza and the death car. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the Plaza and the death car responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the Plaza and the death car follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VII and its treatment of the Plaza and the death car. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VII as evidence for a larger claim about the Plaza and the death car in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the Plaza and the death car. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *I think he realizes that his presumptuous little flirtation is over."*

As used in the text, what does the word "flirtation" most nearly mean?

A. playful behavior intended to arouse sexual interest

B. cause to be slowed down or delayed

C. becoming engaged to marry

D. showing; pointing to

2. *He was calling up at Daisy's request—would I come to lunch at her house tomorrow? Miss Baker would be there. Half an hour later Daisy herself telephoned and seemed relieved to find that I was coming. Something was up. And yet I couldn't believe that they would choose this occasion for a scene—especially for the rather harrowing scene that Gatsby had outlined in the garden.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VII"?

A. Gatsby's death

B. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

C. The Plaza and the death car

D. Gatsby's party

**SAT key:** 1. A (playful behavior intended to arouse sexual interest); 2. C (The Plaza and the death car)

# Lesson 9: Chapter VIII

**Focus:** Gatsby's death

**Content note (murder, suicide):** Wilson shoots Gatsby and then himself. Use the safe-messaging script; discuss grief, misinformation and Tom's role, not methods.
**Student preview:** This chapter includes a killing and a suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read.
**Suggested language:** "How did a lie lead to these deaths?"
**Safe messaging:** Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Gatsby tells Nick of his love for Daisy in 1917. Nick tells him 'They're a rotten crowd.' Michaelis comforts Wilson, who believes God sees everything. Wilson tracks down Gatsby's house, shoots him in his pool, then kills himself.

**Background:** Fitzgerald alternates Nick's account with the testimony of Michaelis, the Greek coffee-shop owner beside Wilson's garage, as at an inquest. Wilson's belief that the billboard eyes are God's draws on the period's loss of traditional faith that writers such as T. S. Eliot (The Waste Land, 1922) described.

**Significance:** Gatsby dies waiting for a call that never comes, still loyal to Daisy; Wilson, misled by Tom, becomes the instrument of the rich couple's carelessness. Nick's compliment is the only judgment he speaks aloud to Gatsby.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*When should a friend speak up? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the American Dream because.... Content note before we start: This chapter includes a killing and a suicide. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.*
**Prompt:** When should a friend speak up?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to the American Dream because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Gatsby dies still believing.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: flinched — pulled back quickly from fear or pain; penniless — not having enough money to pay for necessities; braided — make by braiding or interlacing; revolved — turn on or around an axis or a center; thanking — expressing gratitude to.*
**Words:** flinched: pulled back quickly from fear or pain · penniless: not having enough money to pay for necessities · braided: make by braiding or interlacing · revolved: turn on or around an axis or a center · thanking: expressing gratitude to

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*Fitzgerald alternates Nick's account with the testimony of Michaelis, the Greek coffee-shop owner beside Wilson's garage, as at an inquest. Wilson's belief that the billboard eyes are God's draws on the period's loss of traditional faith that writers such as T. S. Eliot (The Waste Land, 1922) described. Gatsby dies waiting for a call that never comes, still loyal to Daisy; Wilson, misled by Tom, becomes the instrument of the rich couple's carelessness. Nick's compliment is the only judgment he speaks aloud to Gatsby. Characterization: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call. Symbolism: Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's. Structure: Gatsby is shot in his pool. Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "stood there for a minute and then turned out the light" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 3).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "They're a rotten crowd" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). Nick's verdict. That is characterization at work: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call.*

> *They're a rotten crowd* (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45)

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "They're a rotten crowd" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45). Nick's verdict. That is characterization at work: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Nick's praise. Look at the craft: Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's. Ask: How does this line connect to the American Dream? Expected: Gatsby dies still believing. (Nick's praise.)*

> *You're worth the whole damn bunch put together* (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45)

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Nick's praise. Look at the craft: Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to the American Dream?
**Expected answer:** Gatsby dies still believing. (Nick's praise.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
*Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's death? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of Gatsby's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. When the text says "God sees everything" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104), it shows this directly. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.*
**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's death? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of Gatsby's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
**Exemplar:** Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. When the text says "God sees everything" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104), it shows this directly. He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
*Anchor question: When should a friend speak up? Is Nick right about Gatsby?*
**Anchor question:** When should a friend speak up?
**Facilitation:** Is Nick right about Gatsby?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's death? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. ("God sees everything", Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Gatsby's death? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. ("God sees everything", Chapter VIII, paragraph 104). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes Gatsby's death. Key takeaway: Gatsby dies still believing.*

Total: 90 minutes.

### *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

**Literary elements**

- **Characterization:** Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call.
- **Symbolism:** Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's.
- **Structure:** Gatsby is shot in his pool.

**Themes and how they develop**

- **the American Dream:** Gatsby dies still believing.

**Symbols and motifs**

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: “stood there for a minute and then turned out the light” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 3).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: “men had already loved Daisy—it increased her value in his eyes. He felt their presence all about the house, pervading the air” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 10).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) Nick's verdict.
- “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45) Nick's praise.
- “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104) Wilson on the eyes.
- “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance.
- “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 110) Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich.
**Evidence:** “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104)
**Reasoning:** He shouts "They're a rotten crowd" and "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together," while Wilson insists "God sees everything" to the billboard eyes.

### *Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **flinched** (verb) | pulled back quickly from fear or pain | *But when he heard himself say this, he flinched and began to cry “Oh, my God!” again in his groaning voice.* | |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **penniless** (adjective) | not having enough money to pay for necessities | *However glorious might be his future as Jay Gatsby, he was at present a penniless young man without a past, and at any moment the invisible cloak of his uniform might slip from his shoulders.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **braided** (verb) | make by braiding or interlacing | *There was nothing in it but a small, expensive dog-leash, made of leather and braided silver.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **revolved** (verb) | turn on or around an axis or a center | *The touch of a cluster of leaves revolved it slowly, tracing, like the leg of transit, a thin red circle in the water.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **thanking** (verb) | expressing gratitude to | *We were always thanking him for that—I and the others.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **vestibule** (noun) | an entrance hall | *He went out to the open vestibule and sat down on a folding-chair, and the station slid away and the backs of unfamiliar buildings moved by.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **tracing** (verb) | following the course of; marking out | *The touch of a cluster of leaves revolved it slowly, tracing, like the leg of transit, a thin red circle in the water.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **dejection** (noun) | a state of melancholy depression | *Crossing his lawn, I saw that his front door was still open and he was leaning against a table in the hall, heavy with dejection or sleep.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **bathing** (verb) | cleanse the entire body | *At two o'clock Gatsby put on his bathing-suit and left word with the butler that if anyone phoned word was to be brought to him at the pool.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **accidental** (adjective) | happening by chance | *A small gust of wind that scarcely corrugated the surface was enough to disturb its accidental course with its accidental burden.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. When should a friend speak up?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the past and time?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19,

20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

### Literal / recall

1. What did Gatsby wait for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Daisy's call.
2. What does Wilson do after shooting Gatsby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He shoots himself.
3. Where is Gatsby shot? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: In his pool
4. Who shoots him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: George Wilson
5. What does Nick tell Gatsby? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: They're a rotten crowd
6. What does Wilson believe watches? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: God through Eckleburg's eyes
7. Who comforts Wilson? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Michaelis
8. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter VIII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby tells Nick of his love for Daisy in 1917. Nick tells him 'They're a rotten crowd.' Michaelis comforts Wilson, who believes God sees everything. Wilson tracks down Gatsby's house, shoots him in his pool, then kills himself.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter VIII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does “Chapter VIII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Nick's praise meaningful? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He disapproved of Gatsby from beginning to end.
2. What does the pool suggest? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The end of summer and dream.
3. What does “Chapter VIII” suggest about Gatsby's death? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Gatsby dies waiting for a call that never comes, still loyal to Daisy; Wilson, misled by Tom, becomes the instrument of the rich couple's carelessness. Nick's compliment is the only judgment he speaks aloud to Gatsby.
4. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
5. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about Gatsby's death? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “They’re a rotten crowd” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's verdict. On symbolism:

Wilson sees Eckleburg's eyes as God's. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that begins “But he knew that he was in Daisy’s house by a colossal accident.”, why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatsby tells Nick of his love for Daisy in 1917. Nick tells him 'They're a rotten crowd.' Michaelis comforts Wilson, who believes God sees everything. Wilson tracks down Gatsby's house, shoots him in his pool, then kills himself.
8. How does “Chapter VIII” build on “Chapter VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's praise. On structure: Gatsby is shot in his pool. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104): Wilson on the eyes. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “When should a friend speak up?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Did Gatsby die for a dream or a lie? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned argument.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Who led Wilson to Gatsby? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Tom.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 110): Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “Gatsby dies waiting for a call that never comes, still loyal to Daisy; Wilson, misled by Tom, becomes the instrument of the rich couple's carelessness. Nick's compliment is the only judgment he

speaks aloud to Gatsby." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

**Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: "They're a rotten crowd" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's verdict. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: "You're worth the whole damn bunch put together" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's praise. On characterization: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of "Chapter VIII" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Gatsby's death? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: "God sees everything" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104): Wilson on the eyes. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about "Chapter VIII": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: "He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Gatsby's past with Daisy told without romance. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to illusion and reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: "A new world, material without being real, where poor ghosts, breathing dreams like air, drifted fortuitously about" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 110): Nick imagines Gatsby's last moments: the dream world collapses. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: "They're a rotten crowd" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's verdict. On

characterization: Gatsby tells Nick about Daisy in 1917; he waits in vain for her call. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how “Chapter VIII” treats Gatsby's death with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “You’re worth the whole damn bunch put together” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 45): Nick's praise. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Predict what “Chapter IX” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: Nick's final words to Gatsby show his judgment of the rich. Useful evidence: “God sees everything” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 104): Wilson on the eyes. Theme link: Gatsby dies still believing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Where is Gatsby shot?
   A. In the library
   B. In his car
   C. At the Plaza
   D. In his pool
2. Who shoots him?
   A. Wolfshiem
   B. Daisy
   C. George Wilson
   D. Tom
3. What does Nick tell Gatsby?
   A. Confess
   B. Run away
   C. They're a rotten crowd
   D. Forget her

4. What does Wilson believe watches?
   A. Tom
   B. Gatsby
   C. The police
   D. God through Eckleburg's eyes
5. Who comforts Wilson?
   A. Michaelis
   B. Nick
   C. Catherine
   D. Tom
6. In the line “But when he heard himself say this, he flinched and began to cry “Oh, my God!” again in his groaning voice.”, what does “flinched” most nearly mean?
   A. turn on or around an axis or a center
   B. not having enough money to pay for necessities
   C. make by braiding or interlacing
   D. pulled back quickly from fear or pain
7. In the line “However glorious might be his future as Jay Gatsby, he was at present a penniless young man without a past, and at any moment the invisible cloak of his uniform might slip from his shoulders.”, what does “penniless” most nearly mean?
   A. not having enough money to pay for necessities
   B. pulled back quickly from fear or pain
   C. make by braiding or interlacing
   D. turn on or around an axis or a center

**Answer key:** 1. D (In his pool); 2. C (George Wilson); 3. C (They're a rotten crowd); 4. D (God through Eckleburg's eyes); 5. A (Michaelis); 6. D (pulled back quickly from fear or pain); 7. A (not having enough money to pay for necessities)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VIII,” how does Fitzgerald show Gatsby's death? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VIII, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of Gatsby's death? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of Gatsby's death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Gatsby's death. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VIII suggests about Gatsby's death. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses characterization in Chapter VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of Gatsby's death. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Gatsby's death responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter VIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Gatsby's death follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VIII and its treatment of Gatsby's death. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VIII as evidence for a larger claim about Gatsby's death in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Gatsby's death. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *There was nothing in it but a small, expensive dog-leash, made of leather and braided silver.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “braided” most nearly mean?

   A. make by braiding or interlacing

   B. happening by chance

C. a state of melancholy depression

D. cleanse the entire body

2. *But he knew that he was in Daisy's house by a colossal accident. However glorious might be his future as Jay Gatsby, he was at present a penniless young man without a past, and at any moment the invisible cloak of his uniform might slip from his shoulders. So he made the most of his time. He took what he could get, ravenously and unscrupulously—eventually he took Daisy one still October night, took her because he had no real right to touch her hand.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VIII"?

A. The Plaza and the death car

B. The reunion

C. Gatsby's death

D. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans

**SAT key:** 1. A (make by braiding or interlacing); 2. C (Gatsby's death)

# Lesson 10: Chapter IX

**Focus:** the funeral and the meaning of the dream

Teacher only · spoilers

Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father, Henry Gatz, arrives with a boyhood schedule of self-improvement. Wolfshiem refuses to come. Nick ends things with Jordan, meets Tom, and decides to return West. He reflects on the green light and the American dream.

**Background:** The funeral's emptiness contrasts with the crowds at the parties. Henry Gatz's pride in his son's wealth and the boyhood 'schedule' echo Benjamin Franklin's famous plan of self-improvement in his Autobiography, a founding text of the American self-made man.

**Significance:** Nick moves from Gatsby's story to America's: the Dutch sailors' 'fresh, green breast of the new world' links Gatsby's longing to the nation's founding dream, and the last sentence makes the struggle against the past universal.

*Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)*

**0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
*What lasts after a dream ends? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to carelessness and morality because....*
**Prompt:** What lasts after a dream ends?
**Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to carelessness and morality because…
**Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Tom and Daisy are careless people.

**8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: ferryboat — a boat that carries people across water; breaths — the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing; sideboard — a long dining-room cabinet with a flat top; retreated — pull back or move away or backward; suspicions — an impression that something might be the case. “ferryboat”: ferry, from Old English ferian "to carry, transport," + boat.*
**Words:** ferryboat: a boat that carries people across water · breaths: the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing · sideboard: a long dining-room cabinet with a flat top · retreated: pull back or move away or backward · suspicions: an impression that something might be the case

**18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)**
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
*The funeral's emptiness contrasts with the crowds at the parties. Henry Gatz's pride in his son's wealth and the boyhood 'schedule' echo Benjamin Franklin's famous plan of self-improvement in his Autobiography, a founding text of the American self-made man. Nick moves from Gatsby's story to America's: the Dutch sailors' 'fresh, green breast of the new world' links Gatsby's longing to the nation's founding dream, and the last sentence makes the struggle against the past universal. Characterization: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives. Structure: Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors. Symbolism: the green light and the "fresh, green breast of the new world." Watch for the green light: The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "and untrue. When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would" (Chapter IX, paragraph 2).*

**28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)**
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
*I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154). Nick's verdict. That is characterization at work: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives.*

> *They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money (Chapter IX, paragraph 154)*

**Think-aloud:** I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154). Nick's verdict. That is characterization at work: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives.

**40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)**
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
*Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Humans keep striving forward but are pulled back. Expected link: the past and time. Ask: How does this line connect to carelessness and morality? Expected: Tom and Daisy are careless people. (The ending.)*

> *So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past (Chapter IX, paragraph 162)*

**Ask:** What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
**Expected answer:** Humans keep striving forward but are pulled back. Expected link: the past and time.
**Ask:** How does this line connect to carelessness and morality?
**Expected answer:** Tom and Daisy are careless people. (The ending.)

**55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)**

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

*Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. When the text says "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154), it shows this directly. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past."*

**Task:** Annotate the chapter for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

**Exemplar:** The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. When the text says "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154), it shows this directly. Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past."

**70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)**

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

*Anchor question: What lasts after a dream ends? Is the ending hopeful or tragic?*

**Anchor question:** What lasts after a dream ends?

**Facilitation:** Is the ending hopeful or tragic?

**80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)**
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
*Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. ("They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money", Chapter IX, paragraph 154). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.*
**Exit ticket:** In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Support it with one short quotation.
**Answer:** Model answer: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. ("They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money", Chapter IX, paragraph 154). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

**87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
*Today we saw how characterization shapes the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Key takeaway: Tom and Daisy are careless people.*

Total: 90 minutes.

## *Teacher analysis (spoilers)*

### Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives.
- **Structure:** Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors.
- **Symbolism:** the green light and the "fresh, green breast of the new world."

### Themes and how they develop

- **carelessness and morality:** Tom and Daisy are careless people.

### Symbols and motifs

- **the green light:** The light at the end of Daisy's dock: Gatsby's dream, distant and unreachable, and finally the "orgiastic future" that recedes before everyone. In this chapter: "and untrue. When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would" (Chapter IX, paragraph 2).
- **eyes and seeing:** The billboard eyes of Doctor T. J. Eckleburg, the owl-eyed man and Nick's watching: who sees, who judges, and whether anyone is watching at all. In this chapter: "of character about it too —looked at the coroner with determined eyes under that corrected brow of hers, and swore that her sister" (Chapter IX, paragraph 2).

**Key quotations** (checked against the reading text)

- "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154) Nick's verdict.
- "a fresh, green breast of the new world" (Chapter IX, paragraph 159) The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream.
- "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us" (Chapter IX, paragraph 161) The dream.
- "So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past" (Chapter IX, paragraph 162) The ending.

**Model claim-evidence-reasoning**

**Claim:** The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition.
**Evidence:** "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154)
**Reasoning:** Nick condemns the "careless people, Tom and Daisy" who "retreated back into their money," but says "Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us," and ends with "boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past."

*Vocabulary with etymology notes*

| Word | Definition (in this sentence) | In context | Word history |
|---|---|---|---|
| **ferryboat** (noun) | a boat that carries people across water | *Most of the big shore places were closed now and there were hardly any lights except the shadowy, moving glow of a ferryboat across the Sound.* | "ferryboat": ferry, from Old English ferian "to carry, transport," + boat. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/ferry) |
| **breaths** (noun) | the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing | *We drew in deep breaths of it as we walked back from dinner through the cold vestibules, unutterably aware of our identity with this country for one strange hour, before we melted indistinguishably into it again.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **sideboard** (noun) | a long dining-room cabinet with a flat top | *"And if you think I didn't have my share of suffering—look here, when I went to give up that flat and saw that damn box of dog biscuits sitting there on the sideboard, I sat down and cried like a baby.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **retreated** (verb) | pull back or move away or backward | *They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money or their vast carelessness, or* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | *whatever it was that kept them together, and let other people clean up the mess they had made …* | |
| **suspicions** (noun) | an impression that something might be the case | *When Michaelis's testimony at the inquest brought to light Wilson's suspicions of his wife I thought the whole tale would shortly be served up in racy pasquinade—but Catherine, who might have said anything, didn't say a word.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **staying** (verb) | remaining | *"Well, the fact is—the truth of the matter is that I'm staying with some people up here in Greenwich, and they rather expect me to be with them tomorrow.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **newspaper** (noun) | a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements | *After two years I remember the rest of that day, and that night and the next day, only as an endless drill of police and photographers and newspaper men in and out of Gatsby's front door.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |
| **flinched** (verb) | pulled back quickly from fear or pain | *But when he heard himself say this, he flinched and began to cry "Oh, my God!" again in his groaning voice.* | Student look-up (not yet verified) |

### *Discussion questions*

1. What lasts after a dream ends?
2. Where does structure appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with illusion and reality?

### *Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)*

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

#### Literal / recall

1. Who refuses to come? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Wolfshiem and Klipspringer.
2. What does Nick do with Jordan? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He ends things with her.

3. Who comes to the funeral? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others
4. What does Gatz show Nick? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A boyhood schedule
5. What does Tom admit? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He told Wilson where Gatsby lived
6. Where does Nick go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Back West
7. What is the final image? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Boats against the current
8. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter IX" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father, Henry Gatz, arrives with a boyhood schedule of self-improvement. Wolfshiem refuses to come. Nick ends things with Jordan, meets Tom, and decides to return West. He reflects on the green light and the American dream.
9. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter IX"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
10. Where and when does "Chapter IX" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

### Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Gatz's schedule matter? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: It shows the boy's self-making.
2. Why does Nick move West? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Disillusionment with the East.
3. What does "Chapter IX" suggest about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Nick moves from Gatsby's story to America's: the Dutch sailors' 'fresh, green breast of the new world' links Gatsby's longing to the nation's founding dream, and the last sentence makes the struggle against the past universal.
4. Find one example of structure in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
5. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154): Nick's verdict. On symbolism: the green light and the "fresh, green breast of the new world." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that begins "After two years I remember the rest of that day, and that night and the next day, only as an endless drill of police and photographers and newspaper men in and out of Gatsby's…", why might Fitzgerald have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

7. What causes the main turn in “Chapter IX”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father, Henry Gatz, arrives with a boyhood schedule of self-improvement. Wolfshiem refuses to come. Nick ends things with Jordan, meets Tom, and decides to return West. He reflects on the green light and the American dream.
8. How does “Chapter IX” build on “Chapter VIII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159): The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. On structure: Nick's final judgment of Tom and Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161): The dream. On characterization: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. The bell-ringer asked: “What lasts after a dream ends?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

**Evaluative / synthesis / creative**

1. Is the American Dream dead at the end? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162): The ending. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Does Nick change? [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: An evaluation.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154): Nick's verdict. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. A critic might argue: “Nick moves from Gatsby's story to America's: the Dutch sailors' 'fresh, green breast of the new world' links Gatsby's longing to the nation's founding dream, and the last sentence makes the struggle against the past universal.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a

human condition. Useful evidence: “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159): The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161): The dream. On characterization: Almost no one comes to Gatsby's funeral; his father arrives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter IX” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the funeral and the meaning of the dream? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past” (Chapter IX, paragraph 162): The ending. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter IX”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money” (Chapter IX, paragraph 154): Nick's verdict. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Connect this chapter to carelessness and morality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Fitzgerald need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “a fresh, green breast of the new world” (Chapter IX, paragraph 159): The Dutch sailors' first sight of America: the original dream. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Is the structure in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: “Gatsby believed in the green light, the orgiastic future that year by year recedes before us” (Chapter IX, paragraph 161): The dream. On structure: Nick's final judgment of Tom and

Daisy and his reflection on the Dutch sailors. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Compare how "Chapter IX" treats the funeral and the meaning of the dream with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Great Gatsby see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: "So we beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the past" (Chapter IX, paragraph 162): The ending. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. As the final chapter, does this ending resolve illusion and reality? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
    **Answer guidance:** A defensible line of argument: The final chapter universalizes Gatsby's dream as a human condition. Useful evidence: "They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money" (Chapter IX, paragraph 154): Nick's verdict. Theme link: Tom and Daisy are careless people. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

### *Annotation focus*

- **Structure:** look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

### *Chapter quiz*

1. Who comes to the funeral?
   A. Tom
   B. Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others
   C. Daisy
   D. Hundreds
2. What does Gatz show Nick?
   A. A letter
   B. A photograph of Daisy
   C. A will
   D. A boyhood schedule
3. What does Tom admit?
   A. He loved Myrtle more
   B. Nothing
   C. He told Wilson where Gatsby lived
   D. He was driving

4. Where does Nick go?
   A. Back West
   B. To Europe
   C. To East Egg
   D. To Chicago
5. What is the final image?
   A. Boats against the current
   B. A green light alone
   C. A funeral
   D. A car
6. In the line "Most of the big shore places were closed now and there were hardly any lights except the shadowy, moving glow of a ferryboat across the Sound.", what does "ferryboat" most nearly mean?
   A. the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing
   B. pull back or move away or backward
   C. a boat that carries people across water
   D. a long dining-room cabinet with a flat top
7. In the line "We drew in deep breaths of it as we walked back from dinner through the cold vestibules, unutterably aware of our identity with this country for one strange hour, before we melted indistinguishably into it again.", what does "breaths" most nearly mean?
   A. a long dining-room cabinet with a flat top
   B. a boat that carries people across water
   C. pull back or move away or backward
   D. the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing

**Answer key:** 1. B (Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others); 2. D (A boyhood schedule); 3. C (He told Wilson where Gatsby lived); 4. A (Back West); 5. A (Boats against the current); 6. C (a boat that carries people across water); 7. D (the process of taking in and expelling air during breathing)

### *Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)*

**Middle School** (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter IX," how does Fitzgerald show the funeral and the meaning of the dream? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

**HS Freshman** (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter IX, how does Fitzgerald develop the idea of the funeral and the meaning of the dream? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the chapter helps build that idea.

**HS Sophomore** (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

**HS Senior** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IX suggests about the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's structure and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

**AP** (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how F. Scott Fitzgerald uses structure in Chapter IX to complicate the reader's understanding of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

**College Freshman** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter IX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the funeral and the meaning of the dream responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

**College Sophomore** (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter IX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the funeral and the meaning of the dream follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

**College Junior** (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IX and its treatment of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's structure and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

**College Senior** (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IX as evidence for a larger claim about the funeral and the meaning of the dream in The Great Gatsby. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

**Graduate / PhD** (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the funeral and the meaning of the dream. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Great Gatsby.

### *SAT-style questions*

1. *"And if you think I didn't have my share of suffering—look here, when I went to give up that flat and saw that damn box of dog biscuits sitting there on the sideboard, I sat down and cried like a baby.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "sideboard" most nearly mean?

   A. a long dining-room cabinet with a flat top
   B. remaining
   C. a daily or weekly publication on folded sheets; contains news and articles and advertisements
   D. pulled back quickly from fear or pain

2. *After two years I remember the rest of that day, and that night and the next day, only as an endless drill of police and photographers and newspaper men in and out of Gatsby's front door. A rope stretched across the main gate and a policeman by it kept out the curious, but little boys soon discovered that they could enter through my yard, and there were always a few of them clustered open-mouthed about the pool. Someone with a positive manner, perhaps a detective, used the expression "madman" as he bent over Wilson's body that afternoon, and the adventitious authority of his voice set the key for the newspaper reports next morning.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IX"?

   A. Nick, the Eggs and the Buchanans
   B. The funeral and the meaning of the dream
   C. The reunion
   D. Gatsby's death

**SAT key:** 1. A (a long dining-room cabinet with a flat top); 2. B (The funeral and the meaning of the dream)

# Whole-book test

**The Great Gatsby: whole-book test** · 90 minutes

## Part I: Multiple choice

1. Where does Nick rent a house?
   A. East Egg
   B. Chicago
   C. Manhattan
   D. West Egg
2. What business has Nick come East to learn?
   A. Medicine
   B. Law
   C. Bonds
   D. Journalism
3. What lies between West Egg and New York?
   A. A golf course
   B. A lake
   C. A forest
   D. A valley of ashes
4. Whose eyes look out from the billboard?
   A. Gatsby's
   B. Tom's
   C. Doctor T. J. Eckleburg's
   D. Wilson's
5. How is Nick invited?
   A. By phone
   B. He is not invited
   C. By Daisy
   D. A formal note delivered by a chauffeur
6. What surprises the owl-eyed man?
   A. The champagne
   B. Gatsby is young
   C. The books are real
   D. The orchestra
7. What does Gatsby claim about his family?
   A. Wealthy people in the Middle West, all dead

B. Poor farmers

C. Royalty

D. Bankers in New York

8. Who is Meyer Wolfshiem?

A. A golfer

B. Daisy's father

C. A gambler who fixed the World Series

D. A senator

9. Where does the reunion take place?

A. Nick's house

B. Gatsby's mansion

C. The Plaza

D. Daisy's house

10. What is the weather during the reunion?

A. Rain

B. Fog

C. Heat wave

D. Snow

11. What was Gatsby's real name?

A. Jim Carraway

B. Gus Gatz

C. Jay Cody

D. James Gatz

12. Who mentored Gatsby?

A. Dan Cody

B. Tom Buchanan

C. Nick's father

D. Meyer Wolfshiem

13. Where is the confrontation?

A. Nick's office

B. Gatsby's house

C. The valley of ashes

D. The Plaza Hotel

14. Whose car does Tom drive to the city?

A. Jordan's

B. Nick's

C. Gatsby's

D. Wilson's

15. Where is Gatsby shot?
    A. In the library
    B. In his car
    C. At the Plaza
    D. In his pool
16. Who shoots him?
    A. Wolfshiem
    B. Daisy
    C. George Wilson
    D. Tom
17. Who comes to the funeral?
    A. Tom
    B. Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others
    C. Daisy
    D. Hundreds
18. What does Gatz show Nick?
    A. A letter
    B. A photograph of Daisy
    C. A will
    D. A boyhood schedule

## Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how the American Dream develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
2. Explain how class and money develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
3. Explain how the past and time develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.

## Part III: Essay

Choose one of the novel's central concerns (the American Dream, class and money, the past and time, illusion and reality, carelessness and morality) and argue how the ending reframes it.

## Answer key

**Answer key:** 1. D (West Egg); 2. C (Bonds); 3. D (A valley of ashes); 4. C (Doctor T. J. Eckleburg's); 5. D (A formal note delivered by a chauffeur); 6. C (The books are real); 7. A (Wealthy people in the Middle West, all dead); 8. C (A gambler who fixed the World Series); 9. A (Nick's house); 10. A (Rain); 11. D (James Gatz); 12. A (Dan Cody); 13. D (The Plaza Hotel); 14. C (Gatsby's); 15. D (In his pool); 16. C (George Wilson); 17. B (Gatz, Nick, the owl-eyed man and a few others); 18. D (A boyhood schedule)

# Essay assignments

## Essay: The American Dream

**Middle School** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about the American Dream. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the American Dream in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the American Dream across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the American Dream. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the American Dream in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the American Dream, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of the American Dream in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the American Dream in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the American Dream in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the American Dream in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the American Dream in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Class and money

**Middle School** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about class and money. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops class and money in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops class and money across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of class and money. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of class and money in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of class and money, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of class and money in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on class and money in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on class and money in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about class and money in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on class and money in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: The past and time

**Middle School** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about the past and time. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the past and time in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops the past and time across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the past and time. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the past and time in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the past and time, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of the past and time in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the past and time in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the past and time in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the past and time in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the past and time in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Illusion and reality

**Middle School** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about illusion and reality. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops illusion and reality across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of illusion and reality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of illusion and reality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of illusion and reality in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on illusion and reality in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

## Essay: Carelessness and morality

**Middle School** (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Great Gatsby teaches about carelessness and morality. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

**HS Freshman** (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

**HS Sophomore** (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how F. Scott Fitzgerald develops carelessness and morality across The Great Gatsby. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

**HS Junior** (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Great Gatsby (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of carelessness and morality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

**HS Senior** (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

**AP** (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how F. Scott Fitzgerald's choices in The Great Gatsby (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of carelessness and morality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

**College Freshman** (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Great Gatsby's treatment of carelessness and morality in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

**College Sophomore** (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Junior** (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**College Senior** (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Graduate / PhD** (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on carelessness and morality in The Great Gatsby, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

**Rubric:** Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary, 2026-10-20); other words are student look-ups. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.